

Arithmetic Expression Geometry III: Singular Zero Geometry and Tubes

Branched Pullbacks, Arithmetic Zero Networks, and Topological Transport

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Abstract

Arithmetic expression geometry associates a real assignment to an oriented Riemannian surface and imposes the eikonal identity $|\nabla a|_g^2 = \mu^2 + \lambda^2 a^2$, with $\mu \neq 0$. Its regular zeros are curves, not isolated roots. This paper develops the singular and parameterized zero geometry needed to turn those curves into genuine tubes, while separating them from the finite-root braids carried by complex-valued fields.

We first prove two complementary realization theorems. Conformal rescaling makes every surface submersion into a regular arithmetic expression space. Holomorphic branched pullback is more rigid: a local branch of degree m produces a $2m$ -pronged singular zero and a metric cone of angle $2\pi m$. The latter mechanism yields an arithmetic global model. The projective arithmetic operators $z \mapsto z + \sqrt{2}$ and $z \mapsto -1/z$ generate the $(2, 4, \infty)$ Hecke triangle group. From its normalized Hauptmodul we construct a singular AES whose zero set is the Hecke dessin; after suppressing bivalent vertices it is the $\{\infty, 4\}$ zero network, with four-valent nodes and cone angle 4π .

To separate arithmetic multiplicity from geometric branching, we introduce a zero-history hierarchy and prove the standard relative-divisor decomposition for a supplied monic generically square-free arithmetic polynomial. Irreducible factors over the coefficient field, geometric sheets after scalar extension, and monodromy orbits are distinct levels. A functor assigning such a polynomial or divisor to a general arithmetic history remains an open problem; the Hecke construction is established at the projective-operator quotient level only.

A rank- r parameterized zero-section theorem then gives the exact transversality and properness hypotheses under which a zero incidence is a smooth fiber bundle. For real assignments over a circle with globally oriented vertical tangent bundle, every compact boundaryless proper zero tube is a union of tori. An explicit helical family computes component permutation, mapping-torus decomposition, logarithmic deck shifts, and torus-link traces.

Topology change is confined to a discriminant. Conformal Morse families realize birth/death and reconnection in the singular category; the complex model $w^2 = \tau$ instead describes a branched filling whose boundary is a regular half-twist. Using the arithmetic-holomorphic coordinate of Paper II, every braid is realized by a square-free polynomial root family. Finally, affine conjugation recovers an Alexander quandle. Its ordinary torsion cocycle is exact, whereas a finite-field resonant twisted version represents a nonzero twisted cohomology class. Nevertheless, we prove that its standard state sum for every planar classical link collapses to the Alexander-quandle coloring count. Thus it is not evidence of a new invariant beyond Alexander or Burau. Thread selection, Markov-normalized AEG decorations, and any stronger separation theorem remain open.

Keywords: arithmetic expression geometry; branched pullback; Hecke triangle group; Hauptmodul; relative divisor; zero set; singularity; fiber bundle; braid group; logarithmic covering

Contents

1	Singular AEG and the hierarchy of zero objects	4
1.1	The question	4
1.2	Imported interfaces and new scope	4
1.3	Seven levels that must remain distinct	5
1.4	Principal results	6
1.5	Organization	6
1.6	Conventions	6
2	Local zero models and conformal realization	7
2.1	The regular germ	7
2.2	Conformal realization	8
2.3	Holomorphic branched pullback	8
2.4	Singular zero mechanisms	11
2.5	What local equivalence should preserve	11
3	Multi-zero and logarithmic constructions	11
3.1	A finite and locally finite construction	11
3.2	A downstairs model and its logarithmic pullback	12
3.3	Sheet labels are not automatically topological states	13
3.4	Metric completeness and provenance limits	13
4	Arithmetic zero networks and relative divisors	14
4.1	The projective arithmetic source	14
4.2	The Hecke–Hauptmodul singular AES	15
4.3	Sign-character descent	17
4.4	From zero histories to relative divisors	17
4.5	What is proved, and what remains a program	19
5	Parameterized incidence and discriminants	20
5.1	Ambient families and vertical transversality	20
5.2	The discriminant is not a single equation	21
5.3	Escape to infinity without a critical zero	22
5.4	Boundary control	23
6	Proper zero tubes	23
6.1	The proper-tube theorem	23
6.2	A compact helical AEG tube	24
6.3	Boundary traces and logarithmic sheets	25
6.4	Embedded monodromy versus braid monodromy	26

7	Singular fibers and branched fillings	26
7.1	Real Morse events in the singular category	26
7.2	A regular-to-singular fold wall	26
7.3	The complex branch model	27
7.4	Smooth and holomorphic fillings	28
8	Complex roots, monodromy, and braids	28
8.1	Square-free polynomials as a finite-root interface	28
8.2	Arithmetic-holomorphic braid realization	29
8.3	Logarithmic lifting of root tubes	30
8.4	Boundary braid and discriminant filling	31
9	Threading, affine torsion, and the knot frontier	31
9.1	Threads are additional data	31
9.2	A scalar Markov obstruction	31
9.3	Affine conjugation and the Alexander layer	32
9.4	Twisting, resonance, and a nonzero class	33
9.5	Variable multipliers and the Reidemeister-III anomaly	34
9.6	A historical free-word calculation	35
9.7	The remaining invariant gate	35
9.8	Conclusion	35
A	Metric, regularity, and properness calculations	36
A.1	Conformal scaling identity	36
A.2	Vertical transversality in coordinates	36
A.3	Properness checks	37
A.4	Audit records for the explicit models	37
A.5	Completeness warning	38
B	Configuration spaces, logarithmic lifts, and branch signs	38
B.1	Configuration and braid conventions	38
B.2	Properness of a finite root covering	39
B.3	Gauge calculation for logarithmic roots	39
B.4	Helical trace on the parameter-position torus	39
B.5	The sign of the simple half-twist	40
B.6	Closure equivalence	40
C	Affine and twisted-quandle calculations	40
C.1	Conjugation in the affine group	40
C.2	Twisted cocycle and primitive	41
C.3	The extension calculation	41
C.4	Two coloring-count checks	41
C.5	Variable-multiplier defect	42
C.6	The figure-eight word	42

1 Singular AEG and the hierarchy of zero objects

1.1 The question

Paper I associates to continuous affine evaluation a regular arithmetic expression space

$$(M, g, a; \mu, \lambda), \quad |\nabla a|_g^2 = \mu^2 + \lambda^2 a^2, \quad \mu \neq 0, \quad (\text{AEG})$$

where M is an oriented smooth surface, g is Riemannian, and a is a real-valued assignment function [16]. The right-hand side of (AEG) is strictly positive. Thus a is a submersion, and every nonempty level set—in particular $a^{-1}(0)$ —is a regular curve. An isolated zero, a crossing, a branch point, or a birth/death event cannot be a regular interior zero.

The word *tube* is nevertheless natural. If an assignment varies with a parameter, its zero curves sweep a surface in the product of the arithmetic surface and the parameter space. The central problem is to determine when that swept surface is more than a picture: when it is smooth, when its projection is a fiber bundle, where topology may change, and what additional data are needed before a braid or knot can be extracted.

There is a second problem, logically prior to the tube: why should a complicated zero set be attached to arithmetic expressions at all? Conformal realization can manufacture almost any regular zero pattern, so geometric abundance alone does not answer this question. The main analytic–arithmetic construction of this paper starts instead from the projective operators of Paper I. Translation by $\sqrt{2}$ and negative inversion generate the $q = 4$ Hecke group; its Hauptmodul then produces a branched zero network whose four-valent vertices are forced by the elliptic ramification. This supplies an exact model in which arithmetic operator paths, holomorphic branching, and singular AEG geometry meet.

The historical AEG notes used “tube” for several disjoint unions of ambient geometries. A source audit of the repository and its Git history found no verifiable general construction under the old symbols E_k or $E_{\log}$. Accordingly, this paper does not import those symbols as established objects. It constructs descriptive finite-zero, logarithmic-cover, and helical models from first principles. The distinction matters: an ambient family is not its zero incidence, and a smooth zero incidence is not automatically a tube.

1.2 Imported interfaces and new scope

We use four results of Papers I and II as interfaces rather than redefining them.

1. Paper I proves the regular-zero theorem just recalled and defines a *singular AES*. Its singular set is closed, nowhere dense, and locally essential, and the regular equation holds on the complement.
2. Paper I proves that spatial regularity along the total zero set of a smooth real family makes that total zero set a smooth submanifold and its parameter projection a submersion. It explicitly leaves global triviality open without properness.
3. Paper II equips every oriented regular AES with its underlying complex structure. On the complete basic hyperbolic model, the arithmetic-holomorphic coordinate $w = X + iy$ is a global complex coordinate, and arithmetic holomorphicity is ordinary holomorphicity in w [17].

4. Paper I's bilateral projective evaluation contains translations and negative inversion in $\mathrm{PGL}_2(K)$. Over $K = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2})$ these operators generate the Hecke subgroup used in Section 4. This import is at the operator quotient level and does not identify different raw history words or ordinary arithmetic domains [16].

The first two interfaces concern a real scalar assignment and hence codimension-one zero curves. The third permits complex-valued auxiliary fields and hence codimension-two isolated roots. They must not be conflated.

Definition 1.1 (Stratified singular AES). A *stratified singular AES* is a singular AES in the sense of Paper I together with a specified locally finite Whitney stratification $\mathcal{S}$ of its singular set S . A stratum is called a *singular zero stratum* if it is contained in the closure of $a^{-1}(0) \cap (M \setminus S)$. The stratification is additional control data; it is not claimed to be canonical.

This refinement supplies a language for parameterized Morse examples and branched fillings. It does not solve the classification of singular AEG germs. Indeed, the conformal realization theorem in Section 2 shows that the bare singular-AES category is deliberately flexible.

1.3 Seven levels that must remain distinct

Let $q : X \rightarrow B$ be an ambient family and let s be a real or vector-valued field on X . The following hierarchy fixes our terminology.

Definition 1.2 (Zero-object hierarchy). Write $\mathcal{Z}(s) = s^{-1}(0)$ and $\pi = q|_{\mathcal{Z}(s)}$.

1. $\mathcal{Z}(s)$ is the *total zero set*; no regularity is implied.
2. It is a *smooth zero incidence* if it is a smooth submanifold of X .
3. It is a *proper zero tube* if π is a surjective, proper smooth submersion (with the corresponding neat boundary hypotheses when boundaries are present).
4. It is an *embedded zero tube* when its inclusion in the specified ambient family is retained as part of the data.
5. A *threaded zero tube* is an embedded zero tube together with a specified finite multisection or other explicitly declared one-dimensional thread datum.
6. A *braid closure* is obtained only after a finite moving-point system, an ambient surface, and a closure convention have been fixed.
7. A *knot invariant* is a quantity on closures that has been proved independent of all presentation choices, in particular the appropriate conjugation and stabilization moves.

The hierarchy also exposes a dimension obstruction. A real field on a surface has one-dimensional zero fibers; a complex field has zero-dimensional root fibers. Only the latter produces an ordinary geometric braid without an extra transverse probe.

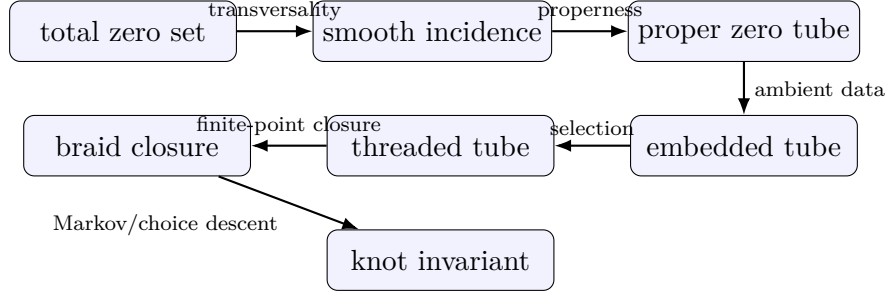


Figure 1: Each arrow requires new hypotheses or data. No arrow in the diagram is automatic from the object to its left.

1.4 Principal results

The paper proves the following claims. Status qualifications are included to make the mathematical boundary visible.

The positive and negative results are complementary. The realization theorems show that tube and braid geometry genuinely occur inside AEG. The flexibility and collapse theorems show that occurrence alone carries little discriminatory power. Any new invariant must come from a natural decoration tied to expression history, and that decoration must survive the relevant quotient.

1.5 Organization

Section 2 proves conformal and holomorphic pullback realization, including finite Blaschke and essential-singularity controls. Section 3 records the flexible parallel and logarithmic models. Section 4 is the arithmetic core: it constructs the $q = 4$ Hecke–Hauptmodul singular AES, proves its character-valued descent, and separates zero histories from relative prime divisors. Sections 5–7 develop parameterized incidence, proper tubes, and singular change. Section 8 treats rank-two root monodromy, and Section 9 applies the Markov and Alexander/Burau novelty gates. The logical order is therefore

$$\begin{aligned}
 &\text{branched analytic germ} \longrightarrow \text{arithmetic zero network} \\
 &\quad \longrightarrow \text{relative divisor and discriminant} \\
 &\quad \longrightarrow \text{tube and monodromy.}
 \end{aligned}$$

1.6 Conventions

All manifolds are smooth, Hausdorff, and second countable. Unless boundary hypotheses are stated, manifolds are boundaryless. The parameters $\mu \neq 0$ and $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$ always belong to the AEG equation; family parameters are denoted by b , t , θ , or τ . The letter t is also used for an affine multiplier only in Section 9, where it cannot be confused with a family coordinate. A deck transformation is denoted D , while T_{cof} denotes the Laurent-module action in twisted quandle cohomology.

For a loop of configurations, a based loop determines a braid element and a free loop determines a conjugacy class. “Invariant” without qualification means an ambient-isotopy invariant of oriented links; annular, transverse, framed, and presentation-dependent data are named explicitly.

Result	Content	Status
Conformal realization	Every smooth submersion on a surface satisfies (AEG) for an explicit conformal metric.	Proved
Branched pullback	A holomorphic branch of degree m gives a $2m$ -pronged essential zero and cone angle $2\pi m$.	Proved
Multi-zero models	Explicit regular AESs have exactly k parallel zero components, or countably many logarithmic lifts.	Proved
$q = 4$ arithmetic network	A Hecke Hauptmodul gives the $\{\infty, 4\}$ zero network, 4π cone nodes, and sign-character descent.	Proved
Relative zero divisor	A supplied monic generically square-free arithmetic polynomial has distinct K -prime, geometric-sheet, Galois, and monodromy levels.	Proved
Incidence theorem	Vertical transversality gives a smooth incidence and a submersion; properness gives a bundle.	Proved with stated hypotheses
Real-tube structure	Compact boundaryless real zero tubes over S^1 with global vertical orientation are unions of tori.	Proved with stated hypotheses
Helical tube	A compact family computes component permutation, logarithmic deck shift, and torus-link boundary traces.	Proved
Singular models	Definite and indefinite Morse events satisfy the AEG equation off an essential singular point.	Proved examples
Root monodromy	Square-free arithmetic-holomorphic polynomial families give proper root coverings and realize every braid.	Proved via Paper II
Affine novelty filter	Stateless scalars collapse to writhe; ordinary affine torsion is exact; resonant finite-field twisted torsion is nonzero but its planar state sum collapses to coloring count.	Proved
Beyond baselines	A Markov-descended, choice-free AEG decoration separates closures not separated by Alexander/Burau baselines.	Open

Table 1: Claim ledger for the main results.

2 Local zero models and conformal realization

2.1 The regular germ

At a regular zero p , the submersion theorem gives coordinates (u, v) centered at p in which $a = \mu u$: take $u = a/\mu$ and choose the sign of v so that (u, v) is positively oriented. This statement concerns the zero germ and the assignment; it does not put the metric into Euclidean form. Equation (AEG) further gives $|\nabla a|_g = |\mu|$ along $a = 0$. Thus a regular zero has one transverse direction with a fixed nonzero speed and one tangent direction. No finite-order singularity can occur there.

The simplest global realization keeps the metric fixed.

Example 2.1 (Cylindrical propagation). On $M = \mathbb{R}_r \times S_\phi^1$ with $g = dr^2 + d\phi^2$, set

$$a_c(r, \phi) = \begin{cases} \frac{\mu}{\lambda} \sinh(\lambda(r - c)), & \lambda \neq 0, \\ \mu(r - c), & \lambda = 0. \end{cases}$$

Then $|\nabla a_c|_g^2 = \mu^2 + \lambda^2 a_c^2$ and $Z(a_c) = \{c\} \times S^1$. This model will yield a proper product tube in Section 6.

2.2 Conformal realization

The following construction is elementary, but it determines the scope of every subsequent singularity claim.

Theorem 2.2 (Conformal realization). *Let (M, h) be an oriented Riemannian surface, let $a \in C^\infty(M, \mathbb{R})$ be a submersion, and fix $\mu \neq 0$ and $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$. The conformal metric*

$$g_a = \frac{|da|_h^2}{\mu^2 + \lambda^2 a^2} h \quad (1)$$

is smooth and positive definite, and $(M, g_a, a; \mu, \lambda)$ is a regular AES.

Proof. Put $g_a = \rho h$. Since da never vanishes and the denominator is positive, ρ is a positive smooth function. The inverse metric is $g_a^{-1} = \rho^{-1} h^{-1}$, so

$$|\nabla a|_{g_a}^2 = |da|_{g_a^{-1}}^2 = \rho^{-1} |da|_h^2 = \mu^2 + \lambda^2 a^2.$$

□

Corollary 2.3 (Singular realization). *Let $a \in C^\infty(M, \mathbb{R})$ have a closed nowhere-dense critical set $S = \text{Crit}(a)$. On $M \setminus S$, define g_a by (1). Then $(M, S, g_a, a; \mu, \lambda)$ is a singular AES. Every point of S is locally essential.*

Proof. Theorem 2.2 applies on $M \setminus S$. If a point $p \in S$ admitted a regular local extension agreeing with a , then $da_p = 0$ would imply $|\nabla a|^2(p) = 0$ for the extended nondegenerate metric, whereas the right-hand side of (AEG) is at least $\mu^2 > 0$. This is impossible. □

2.3 Holomorphic branched pullback

Paper II identifies arithmetic holomorphicity with ordinary holomorphicity in the complex structure carried by an oriented regular AES. The next theorem uses that interface, but the singular metric and its local completion are proved here. The statement therefore does not depend on an unproved singular extension of the function theory.

Theorem 2.4 (Branched-pullback zero germ). *Let Σ be a Riemann surface, let $\Phi : \Sigma \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ be a nonconstant holomorphic map, and write $\Phi = U + iV$. Fix $\mu \neq 0$ and $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$. Put*

$$a_\Phi = V, \quad g_\Phi = \frac{|d\Phi|^2}{\mu^2 + \lambda^2 V^2} \quad \text{on } \Sigma \setminus \text{Crit}(\Phi), \quad (2)$$

where $|d\Phi|^2 = |\Phi'(z)|^2 |dz|^2$ in a holomorphic coordinate. Then

$$(\Sigma, \text{Crit}(\Phi), g_\Phi, a_\Phi; \mu, \lambda)$$

is a singular AES. Every critical point is locally essential.

Suppose $p \in \text{Crit}(\Phi)$, $\Phi(p) \in \mathbb{R}$, and the local degree of Φ at p is $m \geq 2$. Then:

- 1. the zero germ $a_\Phi^{-1}(0)$ has exactly $2m$ half-branches, equally spaced in a suitable holomorphic coordinate;*
- 2. the metric completion of the punctured germ adds one cone point of angle $2\pi m$;*

3. p is a critical zero of the smooth assignment a_Φ , and no smooth nondegenerate regular-AES metric can extend across it.

For $m = 2$ this is a four-pronged zero with cone angle 4π .

Proof. On the target plane consider

$$b(U + iV) = V, \quad h_{\text{lin}} = \frac{dU^2 + dV^2}{\mu^2 + \lambda^2 V^2}.$$

It satisfies $|\nabla b|_{h_{\text{lin}}}^2 = \mu^2 + \lambda^2 b^2$. Away from $\text{Crit}(\Phi)$, formula (2) is exactly $\Phi^* h_{\text{lin}}$, and $a_\Phi = b \circ \Phi$. A holomorphic local diffeomorphism preserves the eikonal identity under pullback, proving regularity on the complement.

At a critical point, $da_\Phi = 0$. A smooth nondegenerate extension satisfying the regular AEG equation would give $0 = |\nabla a_\Phi|^2 \geq \mu^2$, which is impossible. Thus every critical point is locally essential in the sense of Paper I.

At a critical zero of local degree m , the holomorphic local-mapping theorem provides coordinates centered at p and $\Phi(p)$ in which

$$\Phi(z) - \Phi(p) = z^m.$$

Consequently the zero germ is

$$\text{Im}(z^m) = 0,$$

which consists of the $2m$ rays $\arg z = k\pi/m$, $k = 0, \dots, 2m-1$. The target metric is smooth and positive at $\Phi(p)$. If it is written locally as $e^{2\psi(w)}|dw|^2$, its pullback is

$$m^2|z|^{2m-2}e^{2\psi(z^m)}|dz|^2.$$

For a circle $|z| = r$, the ratio of its length to the radial distance from the missing point tends to $2\pi m$. The completion therefore has cone angle $2\pi m$. The last assertion is the essentiality argument already given. $\square$

Remark 2.5 (Pullback naturality and its limit). The theorem is more structured than arbitrary conformal realization: the metric, assignment, zero germ, and cone angle are all pulled back from one holomorphic map. It still does not make every such map arithmetic-natural. A history-derived source for the map is an additional requirement, supplied at the projective operator level by the Hecke construction in Section 4 and left open in greater generality.

Example 2.6 (Finite Blaschke bridge). Let

$$B(z) = e^{i\theta} \prod_{j=1}^n \frac{z - \alpha_j}{1 - \overline{\alpha_j}z}, \quad |\alpha_j| < 1,$$

be a finite Blaschke product. The single holomorphic map $B : \mathbb{D} \rightarrow \mathbb{D}$ supports three related zero objects.

First, $B^{-1}(0)$ is an effective finite divisor of degree n , counted with multiplicity. A family of such products whose roots remain distinct produces the finite root incidence of Section 8. Second, for every phase ϕ , the real assignment

$$a_\phi = \text{Im}(e^{-i\phi}B), \quad g_\phi = \frac{|B'(z)|^2}{\mu^2 + \lambda^2 a_\phi^2} |dz|^2$$

has zero network

$$Z(a_\phi) = B^{-1}(e^{i\phi}\mathbb{R}).$$

At a critical point of local degree m lying over this diameter, the network has $2m$ prongs and the metric completion has cone angle $2\pi m$.

Third, pull back the isolated-zero disc of Paper I, Equation (4), along B . The assignment $a_{\mathbb{D}} \circ B$ has the finite isolated zero set $B^{-1}(0)$, while $B^*g_{\mathbb{D}}$ has cone angle $2\pi m$ at a critical point of local degree m . The declared singular set is $B^{-1}(0) \cup \text{Crit}(B)$. At a simple root the pulled-back radial assignment is nonsmooth. At a multiple root an even power of the radius can become smooth, but the zero still cannot be a regular AES point: its differential vanishes and the pulled-back metric is degenerate there. Thus one holomorphic object links an isolated divisor, phase-dependent real zero networks, and, after parameterization, finite threads or braids.

The roots α_j are arbitrary data. This bridge is a finite universality mechanism, not a proof that an expression history canonically selects B .

Example 2.7 (An analytic-capacity control). Let $M = \{|z| < \varepsilon\}$ and, for $z \neq 0$, set

$$\Phi(z) = \sin(1/z), \quad a(z) = \text{Im } \Phi(z), \quad g = \frac{|\Phi'(z)|^2}{\mu^2 + \lambda^2 a(z)^2} |dz|^2.$$

Assign any value, say $a(0) = 0$, at the origin and declare

$$S = \{0\} \cup \left\{ z_k = \frac{1}{\pi/2 + k\pi} : k \in \mathbb{Z}, |z_k| < \varepsilon \right\}.$$

Since $\Phi'(z) = -\cos(1/z)/z^2$, this is precisely the singular set in M . Writing $z = x + iy$ and $c_k = \pi/2 + k\pi$, the zero set away from the origin is

$$\begin{aligned} Z(a) = \{y = 0\} \\ \cup \bigcup_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} \left\{ \left(x - \frac{1}{2c_k} \right)^2 + y^2 = \frac{1}{4c_k^2} \right\}, \end{aligned} \tag{3}$$

with all sets restricted to $0 < |z| < \varepsilon$. Indeed, $\text{Im } \sin(u + iv) = \cos u \sinh v$, and inversion sends the vertical lines $u = c_k$ to the displayed circles. Each circle meets the real axis at the simple critical point z_k , where Theorem 2.4 gives a four-pronged zero and cone angle 4π . The nodes and circles accumulate at the essential singularity 0. Indeed, $\text{Im } \sin(1/z)$ is unbounded in every punctured neighborhood of the origin, so the arbitrarily assigned value $a(0)$ admits no continuous, hence no regular-AES, local extension.

This example proves analytic capacity: singular AEGs can carry an infinite four-valent zero network. It is not promoted to the arithmetic model of the paper, because the formula does not distinguish expression histories or induce a canonical arithmetic quotient.

Warning 2.8 (Flexibility boundary). When the metric may be chosen as part of the construction, the regular AEG equation admits every smooth submersion, and the singular category admits every smooth function with closed nowhere-dense critical set. Therefore the bare equation does not by itself select an AEG-specific list of singularity types. A classification theorem would require additional naturality or analytic hypotheses, such as a fixed ambient metric, completeness, curvature bounds, controlled metric asymptotics, homogeneity, or derivation from expression history.

The warning is not a defect of the construction. It is a precise division of labor. The equation controls assignment speed relative to a chosen metric; it does not select that metric. Later tube theorems are consequently topological theorems with explicit hypotheses, not rigidity theorems for arbitrary AEGs.

2.4 Singular zero mechanisms

There are at least four mechanisms by which the regular-zero conclusion can fail.

1. The assignment may fail to be differentiable at a point, even though the metric extends there.
2. The assignment may be smooth but critical, forcing the conformal realization metric to degenerate or be removed at that point.
3. The domain may have a boundary or a puncture through which a zero component enters, exits, or escapes.
4. In a parameterized family, the total incidence may remain smooth while its projection to parameter space ceases to be a submersion.

Paper I supplies a verified example of the first mechanism. On the unit disc with $\rho = (\xi^2 + \eta^2)^{1/2}$, it takes

$$g_{\mathbb{D}} = \frac{4}{\lambda^2(1 - \rho^2)^2} (d\xi^2 + d\eta^2), \quad a_{\mathbb{D}} = \frac{2\mu}{\lambda} \frac{\rho}{1 - \rho^2} \quad (\rho > 0), \quad (4)$$

with $a_{\mathbb{D}}(0) = 0$ and $\mu, \lambda > 0$. The metric extends smoothly, the assignment is not C^1 at the center, and the center is its only zero. This is an isolated singular zero, not a normal form for all isolated singular zeros.

The second and fourth mechanisms will appear together in the Morse families of Section 7. The third is the reason properness and boundary control occur explicitly in Definition 1.2.

2.5 What local equivalence should preserve

For clarity, we distinguish three notions that are sometimes compressed into the phrase “same singularity.”

Definition 2.9 (Three local equivalences). For two pointed singular AEGs, a *zero-germ equivalence* is a local diffeomorphism carrying one zero germ to the other. An *assignment-germ equivalence* additionally intertwines the assignments up to a local diffeomorphism of the target fixing zero. An *AEG-germ isomorphism* preserves the assignment, the oriented metric, and the constants (μ, λ) .

The real Morse lemma classifies assignment germs up to a much coarser right-left equivalence. Conformal realization then equips those germs with examples of AEG metrics. It does not show that all AEG-germ isomorphism classes are represented by the displayed metrics, nor that the metric asymptotics are unique.

Open problem 2.10 (Rigidity beyond conformal realization). Find natural hypotheses derived from arithmetic evaluation under which the local singular AEG germ has a finite classification, and determine which of the Morse and branch models of Section 7 survive that restriction.

3 Multi-zero and logarithmic constructions

3.1 A finite and locally finite construction

The regular-zero theorem is local and does not limit the number of connected components globally. The next model gives a direct answer to the existence part of the multi-zero problem.

Theorem 3.1 (Parallel multi-zero model). *Let $h \in C^\infty(\mathbb{R})$ have only simple zeros. On $M = \mathbb{R}^2$ define*

$$a_h(x, y) = e^x h(y) \quad (5)$$

and

$$g_h = \frac{e^{2x}(h(y)^2 + h'(y)^2)}{\mu^2 + \lambda^2 e^{2x} h(y)^2} (dx^2 + dy^2). \quad (6)$$

Then $(M, g_h, a_h; \mu, \lambda)$ is a regular AES and

$$Z(a_h) = \coprod_{h(c)=0} \mathbb{R} \times \{c\}. \quad (7)$$

In particular, if $h_k(y) = \prod_{j=1}^k (y - c_j)$ with distinct c_j , the zero set has exactly k connected components.

Proof. One has

$$da_h = e^x h(y) dx + e^x h'(y) dy, \quad |da_h|_{\text{eucl}}^2 = e^{2x}(h^2 + (h')^2).$$

The simple-zero hypothesis implies that h and h' never vanish simultaneously. The coefficient in (6) is therefore smooth and positive. Theorem 2.2 proves the AEG identity, and e^x never vanishes, so (7) is immediate. $\square$

Remark 3.2 (What the index counts). The polynomial example proves existence of a regular AES with k zero components. It does not prove uniqueness, completeness, homogeneity, or a canonical classification by k . We therefore call it the *parallel k -zero model*, not E_k . The old repository symbol E_k had no stable definition: at different times its subscript suggested construction order, zero count, or singularity count.

Taking $h(y) = \sin y$ gives a countable, locally finite zero family. This example already suggests that countably many visible sheets may be repetitions under a covering group rather than independent components of downstairs geometry.

3.2 A downstairs model and its logarithmic pullback

Let $z = X + iY$ be the standard coordinate on $\mathbb{C}^\times$ and set

$$a_\times(z) = Y, \quad g_\times = \frac{dX^2 + dY^2}{\mu^2 + \lambda^2 Y^2}. \quad (8)$$

Since $|dY|_{\text{eucl}}^2 = 1$, this is a regular AES. Its zero set is the punctured real axis, hence has two components.

Pull (8) back along the exponential covering

$$\exp : \mathbb{C} \longrightarrow \mathbb{C}^\times, \quad x + iy \longmapsto e^{x+iy}.$$

The resulting data are

$$\tilde{a}(x, y) = e^x \sin y, \quad \tilde{g} = \frac{e^{2x}}{\mu^2 + \lambda^2 e^{2x} \sin^2 y} (dx^2 + dy^2), \quad (9)$$

and

$$Z(\tilde{a}) = \coprod_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} \{y = k\pi\}. \quad (10)$$

Theorem 3.3 (Logarithmic zero lift). *The data in (9) form a regular AES and are invariant under the deck transformation*

$$D(x, y) = (x, y + 2\pi).$$

On the labels in (10), D acts by $k \mapsto k + 2$. Thus the countable upstairs zero family has exactly two deck orbits, corresponding to the positive and negative real half-axes downstairs.

Proof. The formula is the pullback of the regular AES (8); it can also be checked directly from $|\mathrm{d}\tilde{a}|_{\mathrm{eucl}}^2 = e^{2x}$. Both $\sin y$ and the metric coefficient are 2π -periodic. Finally, $D(\{y = k\pi\}) = \{y = (k + 2)\pi\}$, proving the orbit statement. $\square$

Remark 3.4 (No singular spine at the missing origin). The coordinate $z = 0$ is absent from $\mathbb{C}^\times$, but the formula $a_\times = Y$ and its metric extend regularly across it. Hence the origin is not a locally essential singularity in the sense of Paper I. The model is a *logarithmic-domain model*, not an essential-singularity model. Calling the missing point a singular spine would erase the local-essentiality condition.

Theorem 3.3 is the rigorous content we retain from the historical $E_{\log}$ intuition:

$$\text{countably many sheets upstairs} = \text{finite downstairs geometry plus deck labels.}$$

No claim is made that it reconstructs every meaning previously attached to $E_{\log}$.

3.3 Sheet labels are not automatically topological states

The label $k \in \mathbb{Z}$ in (10) depends on a choice of fundamental domain. Its parity is invariant under the deck group in this model, but an absolute integer label is not downstairs data. More generally, logarithms of moving complex roots acquire integer shifts whose individual values depend on the chosen lifts; only cycle sums survive the lift gauge. This statement is proved in Section 8 and Appendix B.

There is a second obstruction to interpreting the parallel model as a braid. If $c_1(t) < \dots < c_k(t)$ are distinct real zero positions throughout a one-parameter family, their order cannot change without a collision. The configuration space of k unordered points on a line has contractible components; it does not carry the Artin braid group. Noncommutative braid monodromy requires motion in a surface, which in this paper comes from complex-valued fields, or else a separately declared transverse probe.

3.4 Metric completeness and provenance limits

The models above are exact solutions of the AEG equation, but completeness is not part of their claim. For example, in the parallel model the conformal factor often decays like e^{2x} as $x \rightarrow -\infty$, placing that end at finite metric distance. Completion can add boundary or singular strata and must be audited separately. This is one reason the model record must always list the domain and metric, not only the zero set.

For reference, the construction record is:

Item	Parallel model	Logarithmic model
Domain	$\mathbb{R}^2$	$\mathbb{C} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^\times$
Assignment	$e^x h(y)$	$e^x \sin y = \operatorname{Im}(e^{x+iy})$
Metric	Equation (6)	Equation (9)
Singular set	empty	empty
Zero topology	one line per simple zero of h	countably many lines upstairs, two components downstairs
Global status	regular; completeness not asserted	regular covering model; missing origin removable
Provenance	constructed and proved here	constructed and proved here; historical name used only as motivation

Open problem 3.5 (Natural multi-zero metrics). Classify multi-zero assignments when the metric is fixed by an independent AEG construction, or when completeness, curvature, or expression-history naturality is imposed. Determine whether any canonical index survives those restrictions.

Section 4 gives one nonparallel answer without solving this classification: an automorphic function fixed by a projective arithmetic operator group determines both the metric and a four-valent infinite zero network. The contrast is intentional. The present section proves that multi-zero geometry is analytically abundant; the Hecke construction asks which part of that abundance is forced by arithmetic structure.

4 Arithmetic zero networks and relative divisors

4.1 The projective arithmetic source

Paper I separates literal histories from their induced projective operators. That distinction is decisive here. Over

$$K_4 = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2})$$

the bilateral projective history language contains the two operators

$$\mathsf{T}(\tau) = \tau + \sqrt{2}, \quad \mathsf{J}(\tau) = -\frac{1}{\tau}, \quad (11)$$

represented by

$$T = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & \sqrt{2} \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad J = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Projective evaluation therefore contains the operator subgroup

$$\Gamma_4 = \langle J, T \rangle < \operatorname{PSL}_2(\mathbb{R}), \quad J^2 = (JT)^4 = 1. \quad (12)$$

It is the Hecke triangle group of signature $(2, 4, \infty)$. Its parabolic translation is T , and the elliptic generators have orders 2 and 4. The associated Hecke–Farey and continued-fraction paths are arithmetic paths in the operator quotient, not distinct merely because they have different word spellings [14, 12].

Let

$$\beta : \mathbb{H} \longrightarrow \mathbb{P}^1(\mathbb{C})$$

be the normalized Γ_4 -invariant Hauptmodul. We choose the normalization for which the order-2 elliptic orbit maps to 0, the order-4 elliptic orbit maps to 1, and the cusp orbit maps to ∞ . Thus

$$\Gamma_4 \backslash \mathbb{H}^* \cong \mathbb{P}^1, \quad (\mathcal{E}_2, \mathcal{E}_4, \mathcal{C}) \longmapsto (0, 1, \infty), \quad (13)$$

with finite ramification indices 2 and 4 at the elliptic orbits and a cusp over ∞ . The existence and normalization are standard for the triangle orbifold [3, 6]. If a cited convention interchanges the two finite branch values, we replace its Hauptmodul by $1 - \beta$; this is the only renormalization being made. In particular, in suitable local coordinates,

$$\begin{aligned}\beta(z) &= c_2 z^2 + O(z^3) && \text{at } \mathcal{E}_2, \\ 1 - \beta(z) &= c_4 z^4 + O(z^5) && \text{at } \mathcal{E}_4,\end{aligned}\tag{14}$$

where $c_2 c_4 \neq 0$. In a quotient cusp coordinate q , the Hauptmodul has a simple pole,

$$\beta(q) = c_\infty q^{-1} + O(1), \quad c_\infty \neq 0.\tag{15}$$

4.2 The Hecke–Hauptmodul singular AES

The interval $[0, 1]$ is the edge between the two finite orbifold branch values. The next construction turns its full preimage into an exact AEG zero network.

Theorem 4.1 ($q = 4$ Hecke zero network). *Let β have the normalization (13), fix $\mu \neq 0$ and $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$, and choose a meromorphic square root on $\mathbb{H}$*

$$F^2 = \frac{\beta}{1 - \beta}.\tag{16}$$

Define

$$W = \frac{F - i}{F + i}, \quad s = \log |W|,\tag{17}$$

and

$$a_4 = \begin{cases} \frac{\mu}{\lambda} \sinh(\lambda s), & \lambda \neq 0, \\ \mu s, & \lambda = 0, \end{cases} \quad g_4 = \left| \frac{dW}{W} \right|^2 \quad \text{on } \mathbb{H} \setminus \mathcal{E}_4.\tag{18}$$

Then:

1. $(\mathbb{H}, \mathcal{E}_4, g_4, a_4; \mu, \lambda)$ is a singular AES, and every point of $\mathcal{E}_4$ is locally essential;
2. its total zero set is exactly

$$Z(a_4) = \beta^{-1}([0, 1]);\tag{19}$$

3. points of $\mathcal{E}_2$ are bivalent regular points of the zero set, while points of $\mathcal{E}_4$ are four-valent singular zeros; the metric completion at each latter point has cone angle 4π ;
4. after suppressing the bivalent $\mathcal{E}_2$ vertices, $\beta^{-1}([0, 1])$ is the $\{\infty, 4\}$ Hecke zero network: every vertex has valence four and every face runs out to a parabolic cusp and has infinitely many sides;
5. the punctured regular metric on $\mathbb{H} \setminus \mathcal{E}_4$ is incomplete at $\mathcal{E}_4$, whose points are at finite distance. Its upstairs completion adds 4π cone points. The induced Γ_4 -orbifold length metric, after those points are adjoined, is complete and has its cusp at infinite distance. The underlying coarse quotient has angle π at the image of an order-4 point; none of these statements is smooth geodesic completeness across a regular AES point.

Proof. The divisor of $\beta/(1-\beta)$ on $\mathbb{H}$ has zeros of order 2 along $\mathcal{E}_2$ and poles of order 4 along $\mathcal{E}_4$. It is therefore even. Since $\mathbb{H}$ is simply connected, it admits the meromorphic square root (16), unique up to sign. The equation $F = \pm i$ would imply $F^2 = -1 = \beta/(1-\beta)$, which is impossible. Hence the Cayley transform W extends holomorphically through the poles of F and is a nowhere-zero finite holomorphic function on $\mathbb{H}$.

Away from $\mathcal{E}_4$, dW is nonzero: β has no ramification away from the two elliptic orbits, the square root cancels the order-2 ramification at $\mathcal{E}_2$, and the Cayley map has nonzero derivative. Locally choose a logarithm $\zeta = \log W$. Equations (17) and (18) become

$$s = \operatorname{Re} \zeta, \quad g_4 = |d\zeta|^2.$$

Thus $|\nabla s|_{g_4} = 1$. If $\lambda \neq 0$, then

$$\frac{da_4}{ds} = \mu \cosh(\lambda s), \quad |\nabla a_4|_{g_4}^2 = \mu^2 \cosh^2(\lambda s) = \mu^2 + \lambda^2 a_4^2.$$

The calculation for $\lambda = 0$ is immediate.

The function of s defining a_4 is odd and vanishes only at $s = 0$. Moreover, the Cayley transform carries $\mathbb{P}^1(\mathbb{R})$ to the unit circle, so

$$\begin{aligned} a_4 = 0 &\iff |W| = 1 \iff F \in \mathbb{P}^1(\mathbb{R}) \\ &\iff \frac{\beta}{1-\beta} \in [0, \infty] \iff \beta \in [0, 1]. \end{aligned}$$

This proves (19).

At a point of $\mathcal{E}_2$, expansion (14) gives $F = cz + O(z^2)$ and $W = -1 + c'z + O(z^2)$ with $cc' \neq 0$. The zero set is therefore a smooth arc. At a point of $\mathcal{E}_4$, one has $F = cz^{-2}(1 + O(z))$ and hence

$$W = 1 + c'z^2 + O(z^3), \quad c' \neq 0.$$

Thus $\log W$ has local degree 2. Its real zero has four prongs, and the local metric is the pullback of $|d\zeta|^2$ by a degree-2 branch. The cone-angle calculation in Theorem 2.4 gives 4π . The assignment is critical there, so local essentiality follows from the same $|\nabla a|^2 \geq \mu^2$ obstruction.

The graph $\beta^{-1}([0, 1])$ is the orbit of the finite edge in a $(2, 4, \infty)$ triangle. Four such edge germs meet at an order-4 vertex; an order-2 point merely subdivides an edge. Suppressing those subdivisions gives the standard $\{\infty, 4\}$ Hecke graph. Its complementary regions are the parabolic cusp regions and have infinitely many boundary edges [12].

Finally, Proposition 4.2 below shows that g_4 descends and that $\chi(T) = +1$ for the cusp stabilizer. Thus F and W are single-valued in the quotient cusp coordinate q . The cone calculation places every point of $\mathcal{E}_4$ at finite distance upstairs, with angle 4π . Dividing by its order-4 stabilizer gives angle π on the underlying coarse quotient. At a cusp, (15) gives

$$W = Cq^{\pm 1}(1 + O(q)), \quad \frac{dW}{W} = \pm \frac{dq}{q} + O(dq).$$

The radial integral $\int |dq|/|q|$ diverges. The completed orbifold quotient has a compact core after cusp neighborhoods are removed, so adjoining the finite-distance singular orbit and retaining the infinite cusp end gives the asserted length-metric completeness. The order-2 orbit is smooth upstairs but also has coarse quotient angle π because of its isotropy; its bivalent zero germ distinguishes it from the order-4 singular orbit. $\square$

4.3 Sign-character descent

The square root in (16) is not Γ_4 -invariant. This is not an ambiguity to be hidden; it records a natural signed assignment.

Proposition 4.2 (Character-valued descent). *There is a nontrivial character*

$$\chi : \Gamma_4 \longrightarrow \{\pm 1\}$$

with

$$\chi(J) = -1, \quad \chi(JT) = -1, \quad \chi(T) = +1, \quad (20)$$

such that

$$F(\gamma\tau) = \chi(\gamma)F(\tau), \quad W(\gamma\tau) = \begin{cases} W(\tau), & \chi(\gamma) = 1, \\ W(\tau)^{-1}, & \chi(\gamma) = -1, \end{cases} \quad (21)$$

and consequently

$$\gamma^* g_4 = g_4, \quad a_4(\gamma\tau) = \chi(\gamma)a_4(\tau). \quad (22)$$

Thus the metric and zero network descend to the triangle orbifold, while a_4 descends as a section of the real line bundle associated with χ . It becomes an ordinary scalar assignment on the index-two cover associated with $\ker \chi$.

Proof. Both $F \circ \gamma$ and F square to the same meromorphic function. Their ratio is therefore a constant in $\{\pm 1\}$ on the connected surface $\mathbb{H}$. Composition makes that sign a character. The order-2 stabilizer J acts by $z \mapsto -z$ in the local coordinate for which $F \sim z$, so $\chi(J) = -1$. At the order-4 orbit, JT acts by $z \mapsto \pm iz$ while $F \sim cz^{-2}$, and hence $\chi(JT) = -1$. Since $\chi(JT) = \chi(J)\chi(T)$, this gives $\chi(T) = +1$ and proves (20). Substitution in the Cayley transform gives (21); logarithmic modulus then sends s to $\chi(\gamma)s$. The metric is unchanged and the odd assignment transforms by the same sign. $\square$

This descent statement is one point at which the signed arithmetic history is strictly richer than the unlabelled zero set. It also fixes the global status of the construction: on the orbifold the natural assignment is line-bundle valued, not a silently single-valued real function.

4.4 From zero histories to relative divisors

The Hecke model supplies an arithmetic source for a zero network, but the phrase “different paths to zero” still has several inequivalent meanings. We use the following audit hierarchy.

Level	Equality being imposed
raw word	literal equality of operation symbols and parentheses
marked history	equality of the sequential tree, accumulator, and operand slots
projective operator	equality after the Paper I evaluation map to $\mathrm{PGL}_2(K)$
endpoint	equality after applying an operator to a declared seed or parameter
prime over K	equality inside one irreducible component defined over the coefficient field K
geometric sheet	equality only after extension to $\overline{K}$ or along a local analytic branch

The first four levels form successively coarser process data. The last two are not further syntactic quotients: they are decompositions of the endpoint equation. Distinct operators can agree at one

endpoint, while one K -irreducible component can split into several geometric sheets permuted by Galois or monodromy.

Let B be an integral parameter space over a characteristic-zero field K . If a marked history h and a chosen seed produce a nonzero rational endpoint function $\nu_h \in K(B)^\times$, define its codimension-one zero datum to be the zero part of the principal divisor (ν_h) . The exceptional case $\nu_h \equiv 0$ is not a codimension-one divisor: the entire generic base is a zero condition and must be recorded separately. Operator-equivalent histories give the same endpoint function, but the converse need not hold. For a finite set A of operator classes, one possible encoding on a common regular domain is

$$P_A(b, z) = \prod_{[h] \in A} (z - \nu_h(b)). \quad (23)$$

The vanishing condition $P_A(b, 0) = 0$ records that at least one selected operator history reaches zero. Formula (23) is useful but not canonical: it depends on the seed, the finite selection, multiplicities, and the chosen operator quotient.

The following standard algebraic fact identifies the precise irreducible layer once a monic arithmetic polynomial encoding a declared finite history selection has been supplied.

Theorem 4.3 (Arithmetic and geometric zero components). *Let R be a normal finitely generated domain over a characteristic-zero field k , let $B = \operatorname{Spec} R$, let $K = \operatorname{Frac}(R)$, and let*

$$P(z) = z^n + c_1 z^{n-1} + \cdots + c_n \in R[z]$$

have nonzero discriminant. Write

$$\mathcal{D}_P = V(P) \subset \mathbb{A}_B^1.$$

Then:

1. $\mathcal{D}_P$ is an effective relative Cartier divisor, finite flat of degree n over B ;
2. the distinct irreducible factorization

$$P = \prod_{i=1}^r P_i \quad \text{in } K[z] \quad (24)$$

is the unique decomposition of the generic zero divisor into K -prime components; their closures are the horizontal prime components of the associated Weil divisor on $\mathbb{A}_B^1$;

3. *over a separable closure K^{sep} , the roots of each P_i form one transitive $\operatorname{Gal}(K^{\text{sep}}/K)$ -orbit, although they may be several geometric sheets;*
4. *on the open set $B^\circ = B \setminus V(\operatorname{disc} P)$, the map $\mathcal{D}_P^\circ \rightarrow B^\circ$ is finite étale. If an embedding $k \hookrightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is fixed, set $B_\mathbb{C}^\circ = B^\circ \times_k \mathbb{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}_{P,\mathbb{C}}^\circ = \mathcal{D}_P^\circ \times_k \mathbb{C}$. On each connected component of $(B_\mathbb{C}^\circ)^{\text{an}}$, the analytic covering components of $(\mathcal{D}_{P,\mathbb{C}}^\circ)^{\text{an}}$ are exactly the orbits of topological monodromy on one fiber.*
5. *if D_i denotes the horizontal prime closure belonging to P_i and $\tilde{D}_i$ its normalization, then $\tilde{D}_i \rightarrow B$ is finite and its restriction over B° agrees with the corresponding finite étale covering component.*

Proof. Because P is monic, $R[z]/(P)$ is a free R -module with basis $1, z, \dots, z^{n-1}$; hence the zero scheme is finite flat of degree n . The element P is a non-zero-divisor in $R[z]$, so its vanishing defines an effective Cartier divisor. Unique factorization in the principal ideal domain $K[z]$ gives (24). Taking closures of the generic prime divisors gives all horizontal codimension-one components; monicity precludes a vertical component. Characteristic zero makes every P_i separable, and irreducibility is equivalent to transitivity of the absolute Galois action on its roots. After inverting the discriminant, P and P' generate the unit ideal in the finite algebra, which is the finite-étale criterion. The monodromy assertion is the standard classification of covering components by their orbits. For item (5), schemes of finite type over a field are excellent, so the normalization of each D_i is finite. Over B° , the prime component is already normal because it is finite étale over the normal base; hence normalization changes nothing there [10, 9]. $\square$

The theorem makes “irreducible paths to zero” field-relative. A K -prime component is an arithmetic unit of zero behavior; its geometric branches need not be individually defined over K . The discriminant records finite collisions and ramification in this monic setting. It does not detect the boundary, metric, domain, or nonproper escape mechanisms included in the structural discriminant of Section 5.

Remark 4.4 (Arithmetic reduction interface). Suppose in addition that the family is given by an integral model over a number ring. Let b be a closed point of the parameter base with finite residue field, lying away from the discriminant and every declared bad-reduction locus. Then the degrees of the irreducible factors of the specialized polynomial P_b are the cycle lengths of geometric Frobenius on the corresponding finite étale fiber. At a discriminant point, the local discriminant records failure of étaleness. After normalizing in a splitting field, inertia records the ramified part, while nonmaximality of an order or a bad integral presentation may contribute additional discriminant factors. Thus discriminant primes, inertia, and reduction factorization are genuinely arithmetic zero data, not merely another drawing of complex monodromy. Using them for AEG histories still presupposes the functorial integral polynomial whose construction is posed below [13].

4.5 What is proved, and what remains a program

For the $q = 4$ model, the arithmetic-to-geometric chain established in this paper is

$$\frac{\text{projective arithmetic histories over } K_4}{\text{operator equality}} \supset \Gamma_4 \longrightarrow \beta^{-1}([0, 1]) \longrightarrow (g_4, a_4). \quad (25)$$

If e is one reference edge from an order-2 point to an order-4 point, the edges are translates γe . Equality of two edge labels is equality of the corresponding cosets of the edge stabilizer. Four distinct incident cosets meet at an order-4 endpoint. Raw words representing the same γ have already been identified. Thus the four prongs have an exact operator-coset meaning, but not yet a canonical prime-divisor meaning.

Remark 4.5 (Symmetry is not nonunique factorization). The matrices of Γ_4 are defined over $\mathbb{Z}[\sqrt{2}]$, which is norm-Euclidean and hence a unique factorization domain. The arithmetic richness proved by Theorem 4.1 comes from noncommuting projective operators, Hecke continued-fraction paths, and automorphic uniformization; it does not come from nonunique factorization of elements. If “irreducible paths” is intended specifically to mean inequivalent irreducible factorizations, one must pass to a number ring or order with nontrivial factorization theory, for example a nontrivial class group, and declare whether elements, ideals, units, and order are being quotiented. That extension is not a claim of the present $q = 4$ model.

For completeness, norm-Euclidean follows directly. Given $x + y\sqrt{2} \in \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2})$, choose $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$ with $|x - a|, |y - b| \leq 1/2$. Then

$$\left| N((x - a) + (y - b)\sqrt{2}) \right| = \left| (x - a)^2 - 2(y - b)^2 \right| \leq \frac{1}{2} < 1.$$

Applying this to a quotient gives Euclidean division by the absolute norm.

Open problem 4.6 (History-to-divisor functor). Construct a functorial rule

$$\mathfrak{H} \longmapsto (B_{\mathfrak{H}}, P_{\mathfrak{H}}, \mathcal{D}_{\mathfrak{H}})$$

from a declared category of marked arithmetic histories to parameter spaces, history polynomials, and relative zero divisors, satisfying all of the following:

1. marked-history equivalences and operator equalities act by specified isomorphisms rather than by accidental duplicate factors;
2. ordinary admissibility, projective poles, and chart changes remain visible;
3. composition of histories has a compatible operation on divisors;
4. base change gives the expected Galois and analytic monodromy actions;
5. finite truncations admit a controlled locally finite limit when infinitely many history classes are present.

Determine whether the Hecke zero network is a natural infinite or automorphic instance of this functor, rather than merely its operator-level precursor.

This problem is the main arithmetic naturality gate of the paper. The relative divisor theorem does not solve it: that theorem starts after $P_{\mathfrak{H}}$ has been given. Conversely, the exact Hecke model does not solve it either: it derives a zero network from a projective operator group, but it does not yet associate a finite monic endpoint polynomial to arbitrary AEG histories.

5 Parameterized incidence and discriminants

5.1 Ambient families and vertical transversality

An ambient family is the correct starting object; a tube is a conclusion about a particular incidence inside it.

Definition 5.1 (Ambient AEG family). An *ambient regular AEG family* over a smooth manifold B consists of a smooth fiber bundle $q : X \rightarrow B$ whose vertical tangent bundle $T^V X$ carries a smooth orientation, a smooth vertical Riemannian metric g^V , and a smooth function $A : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that $(M_b, g_b, A_b; \mu, \lambda)$ is a regular AES for every $b \in B$. Its assignment incidence is $\mathcal{Z}(A) = A^{-1}(0)$.

Equivalently, the structure group of the surface bundle is reduced to orientation-preserving diffeomorphisms. Merely choosing an orientation on each fiber without requiring those choices to vary continuously would not orient $T^V X$ and is not sufficient here.

More generally, a *field family over an AEG background* is a rank- r real vector bundle $E \rightarrow X$ with a smooth section s . It need not be the real assignment and need not satisfy the eikonal equation. A complex-valued field is the case $r = 2$ after forgetting complex scalar multiplication.

Let $T^V X = \ker(dq)$ be the vertical tangent bundle. At a zero of s , choose any connection to split TX and define the vertical derivative

$$D^V s : T_x^V X \longrightarrow E_x.$$

Its value at a zero is independent of the chosen local trivialization or connection: it is the derivative of the restricted section on the fiber.

Theorem 5.2 (Parameterized zero-section theorem). *Let $q : X \rightarrow B$ be a smooth fiber bundle and $E \rightarrow X$ a rank- r vector bundle. Suppose the section $s \in \Gamma(E)$ is vertically transverse to the zero section, meaning that $D^V s$ is surjective at every $x \in \mathcal{Z}(s)$. Then:*

1. $\mathcal{Z}(s)$ is a smooth submanifold of X of codimension r ;

2. the restricted projection

$$\pi = q|_{\mathcal{Z}(s)} : \mathcal{Z}(s) \longrightarrow B$$

is a smooth submersion;

3. if π is surjective and proper, then it is a locally trivial smooth fiber bundle.

The third conclusion has the standard relative form when X has boundary and the zero incidence is neat, with the boundary restriction also a submersion.

Proof. Vertical surjectivity implies surjectivity of the full derivative of s , so the zero-section transversality theorem gives the first conclusion. To prove the second, take $\xi \in T_b B$ and a lift $w \in T_x X$. Since $D^V s$ is surjective, there is $v \in T_x^V X$ with $D^V s(v) = -Ds(w)$. Then $w + v \in T_x \mathcal{Z}(s)$ and $Dq(w + v) = \xi$, so $D\pi$ is surjective. The third conclusion is Ehresmann's fibration theorem; the neat relative version follows by the corresponding boundary argument [7]. $\square$

The rank is decisive. If the fibers of q have dimension m , then a regular zero fiber has dimension $m - r$.

Fiber dimension	Field rank	Fiberwise zero	Natural transport
2	1	curves	component and mapping-class monodromy
2	2	points	permutation and braid monodromy

For an ambient regular AEG family, equation (AEG) makes $D^V A = dA_b$ nonzero everywhere, so the first two conclusions are automatic at zero. Properness is not.

5.2 The discriminant is not a single equation

For finite-dimensional polynomial root families, the algebraic discriminant detects repeated roots. A general AEG family has more ways to lose topological stability.

Definition 5.3 (Structural discriminant). For a parameterized zero problem, the *structural discriminant* is the union of the following loci in the parameter space, whenever they are present:

$$\mathcal{D}_{\text{crit}} = \{b : D^V s \text{ fails to be surjective at some zero over } b\},$$

$$\mathcal{D}_{\partial} = \{b : \text{the zero incidence fails the specified neat boundary condition}\},$$

$$\mathcal{D}_{\text{sing}} = \{b : \text{a zero meets the declared singular stratum or the metric degenerates}\},$$

$$\mathcal{D}_{\text{dom}} = \{b : \text{the domain, rank, or regularity class of the field changes}\},$$

$$\mathcal{D}_{\infty} = \{b : \pi \text{ is not proper over any neighborhood of } b\}.$$

If projective continuation is used, its ordinary poles and points at infinity are recorded separately rather than silently absorbed into $\mathcal{D}_{\text{sing}}$.

This definition is a bookkeeping union, not a claim that every stratum is a smooth hypersurface. The geometry of its intersections and a canonical Whitney stratification remain open in general.

For the monic relative divisor of Theorem 4.3, the algebraic discriminant is the scheme-theoretic analogue of the collision/ramification locus, and its complement supports a finite étale root covering. If $K \subset \mathbb{C}$, then on a smooth analytic open of B^{an} where the polynomial is regarded as a complex rank-2 field, this locus is the repeated-root, hence vertical-critical, part of $\mathcal{D}_{\text{crit}}$. Without that analytification and smooth-locus restriction the two categories are not identified. The algebraic discriminant does not see $\mathcal{D}_{\partial}$, $\mathcal{D}_{\text{sing}}$, $\mathcal{D}_{\text{dom}}$, or $\mathcal{D}_{\infty}$. Thus arithmetic factorization and geometric stability fit into the same framework without identifying the polynomial discriminant with the entire structural discriminant.

Corollary 5.4 (Stability off the discriminant). *Let $U \subset B$ be connected. Over U , assume that $q : X \rightarrow B$ and the rank- r bundle E remain fixed smooth bundles, that s is vertically transverse to zero, and that the incidence is surjective and locally proper over U . If a boundary is present, also assume that the incidence is neat and that its boundary projection is a submersion. Then $\pi : \mathcal{Z}(s)|_U \rightarrow U$ is a smooth fiber bundle. In particular, the diffeomorphism type and number of connected components of the fiber are locally constant on U . These are precisely the operative hypotheses encoded by saying that U avoids the relevant pieces of the structural discriminant.*

Proof. For each $b \in U$, local properness supplies a neighborhood V on which the restricted incidence projection is proper. The other hypotheses make that restriction a surjective submersion, including the relative boundary condition when needed. Theorem 5.2 therefore gives a bundle chart over a possibly smaller neighborhood of b . Such charts are exactly the local-triviality assertion. $\square$

5.3 Escape to infinity without a critical zero

The following regular AEG family shows why $\mathcal{D}_{\infty}$ cannot be omitted. Set

$$h_t(y) = y(ty - 1), \quad A(x, y, t) = e^x h_t(y),$$

and equip each copy of $\mathbb{R}^2$ with the smoothly varying conformal metric

$$g_t = \frac{e^{2x}(h_t(y)^2 + (2ty - 1)^2)}{\mu^2 + \lambda^2 e^{2x} h_t(y)^2} (dx^2 + dy^2). \quad (26)$$

At a zero of h_t , its derivative $2ty - 1$ equals -1 or 1 , so it never vanishes. More strongly, h_t and $2ty - 1$ never vanish simultaneously anywhere. Thus every slice is a regular AES by Theorem 2.2.

Its zero fibers are

$$Z(A_t) = \begin{cases} \{y = 0\}, & t = 0, \\ \{y = 0\} \amalg \{y = 1/t\}, & t \neq 0. \end{cases} \quad (27)$$

The total zero incidence is the disjoint union of the plane $y = 0$ and the hyperbolic sheet $ty = 1$. It is smooth, and its projection to t is a submersion. Nevertheless the second component escapes to spatial infinity as $t \rightarrow 0$.

Proposition 5.5 (Nonproper topology change). *The family (26) has no critical zero and no singular metric, but the number of zero components changes at $t = 0$. Its incidence projection is not proper over any neighborhood of 0.*

Proof. Only the last statement remains. For $t_j \rightarrow 0$ with $t_j \neq 0$, the points $(0, 1/t_j, t_j)$ lie in the incidence above a compact parameter interval and have no convergent subsequence. Hence the inverse image of that interval is not compact. $\square$

Thus topology change does not require $dA_t = 0$ at a finite zero. It may occur at infinity. Conversely, a smooth total incidence does not imply a tube.

5.4 Boundary control

If a surface fiber has boundary, a zero curve may be closed or may end on the boundary. For a stable relative tube one requires the incidence to meet $\partial^V X$ neatly and the restriction $\pi : \partial \mathcal{Z} \rightarrow B$ to remain a proper submersion. Without this condition a zero component can be created by tangency to the boundary even though the interior field remains regular. Such a parameter lies in $\mathcal{D}_\partial$, not in $\mathcal{D}_{\text{crit}}$.

Open problem 5.6 (Stratified AEG discriminant). Under natural completeness and asymptotic hypotheses, determine when the five loci in Definition 5.3 admit a locally finite Whitney stratification and when a Thom-type isotopy lemma applies to the combined AEG data.

6 Proper zero tubes

6.1 The proper-tube theorem

Definition 1.2 reserves the word tube for a proper submersion. The resulting structure is strong and concrete.

Theorem 6.1 (Proper real-zero tube). *Let $q : X \rightarrow B$ be an ambient regular AEG family over a connected one-dimensional base, and suppose its assignment incidence $\mathcal{Z} = A^{-1}(0)$ is nonempty and $\pi = q|_{\mathcal{Z}}$ is proper and surjective.*

1. *The map $\pi : \mathcal{Z} \rightarrow B$ is a smooth fiber bundle whose fibers are smooth one-manifolds.*
2. *If the surface fibers have no boundary, every zero fiber is a finite disjoint union of circles.*
3. *If B is an interval, the bundle is globally trivial. For a product ambient family $M \times B$, its compact zero curves over each compact subinterval form a smooth isotopy and hence extend to an ambient isotopy of M . If B itself is a compact interval, this applies over all of B .*
4. *If $B = S^1$, the surface fibers are boundaryless, and the smooth vertical orientation required in Definition 5.1 is fixed, every connected component of $\mathcal{Z}$ is a torus.*

Proof. The AEG equation makes the vertical derivative dA_b nonzero at every point, so Theorem 5.2 proves the bundle assertion. Properness makes every fiber compact. A compact boundaryless one-manifold is a finite union of circles.

A smooth bundle over an interval is trivial. In a product ambient family, a trivialization expresses the inclusions of the compact fiber as a smooth isotopy of embeddings over each compact subinterval; the isotopy-extension theorem extends it to the ambient surface [11].

Over S^1 , the total space is the mapping torus of a diffeomorphism of a finite union of circles. Each orbit of the induced component permutation produces one connected component. After traversing the orbit, the return map is a diffeomorphism of S^1 , so that component is either a torus or a Klein bottle. The smooth orientation of $T^V X$ and the orientation of the base orient X ; the

regular level set $A^{-1}(0)$ is cooriented by dA , hence orientable. The Klein-bottle case is excluded, and every component is a torus. This is where the global vertical-orientation hypothesis is essential: a mapping torus with orientation-reversing fiber monodromy need not be orientable. $\square$

Remark 6.2 (Why vertical orientability is necessary). If the global vertical orientation is dropped, the torus conclusion is false even for a product-type formula. Let $M = \mathbb{R}_r \times S_\phi^1$ with $g = dr^2 + d\phi^2$, $a = \mu r$, and $\lambda = 0$, and form the mapping torus of the AEG isometry $(r, \phi) \mapsto (r, -\phi)$. Its zero incidence is the mapping torus of an orientation-reversing circle map, hence a Klein bottle. It is compact and proper over the parameter circle, but the resulting surface bundle has no smooth orientation of $T^V X$.

Remark 6.3 (What this theorem does not encode). The theorem classifies the abstract total surface under its hypotheses. The embedding $\mathcal{Z} \hookrightarrow X$ may still carry nontrivial ambient monodromy, and no preferred curve inside a torus component has been selected. In particular, a union of zero tori is not yet a knot or link.

Example 2.1 gives an immediate nonempty instance. If B is compact and $c : B \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is smooth, set $a_b = a_{c(b)}$. Then

$$\mathcal{Z} = \{(r, \phi, b) : r = c(b)\} \cong S^1 \times B.$$

It is compact and therefore proper over B . The example is deliberately trivial: it verifies every hypothesis while isolating the content supplied by properness.

6.2 A compact helical AEG tube

The next family is still explicit but has nontrivial component transport. Let

$$M_L = [-L, L]_x \times S_y^1, \quad B = S_\theta^1, \quad L > 0,$$

and choose integers $n \geq 1$ and $m \in \mathbb{Z}$. Define

$$A_{m,n}(x, y, \theta) = e^{nx} \sin(ny - m\theta) \tag{28}$$

and the vertical metric

$$g_{m,n,\theta} = \frac{n^2 e^{2nx}}{\mu^2 + \lambda^2 e^{2nx} \sin^2(ny - m\theta)} (dx^2 + dy^2). \tag{29}$$

Theorem 6.4 (Helical zero-tube theorem). *The family (28)–(29) is an ambient regular AEG family and its zero incidence is a proper neat tube over S^1 . For every θ , the zero fiber consists of $2n$ intervals*

$$y = \frac{m\theta + k\pi}{n}, \quad k \in \mathbb{Z}/(2n). \tag{30}$$

Parameter monodromy acts on the component labels by

$$k \mapsto k + 2m \pmod{2n}. \tag{31}$$

If $d = \gcd(n, m)$, including $d = n$ when $m = 0$, the total incidence is a disjoint union of $2d$ annuli, each containing n/d zero intervals in its monodromy orbit.

Proof. The spatial derivative is

$$d^V A_{m,n} = ne^{nx} \sin(ny - m\theta) dx + ne^{nx} \cos(ny - m\theta) dy,$$

whose Euclidean norm squared is $n^2 e^{2nx}$. Thus (29) is precisely the conformal realization metric, proving the AEG equation. At a zero, the y -derivative is nonzero, so the incidence is smooth and meets $x = \pm L$ neatly. It is closed in the compact manifold $M_L \times S^1$, hence compact and proper.

Equation (30) follows from $ny - m\theta \in \pi\mathbb{Z}$. Increasing θ by 2π changes the label by $2m$, proving (31). Translation by $2m$ on the cyclic group of order $2n$ has $\gcd(2n, 2m) = 2d$ orbits, each of length n/d . The transport fixes the x -coordinate, so the return map after a complete label orbit is the identity on the interval. Its mapping torus is therefore an annulus, not a Möbius band. $\square$

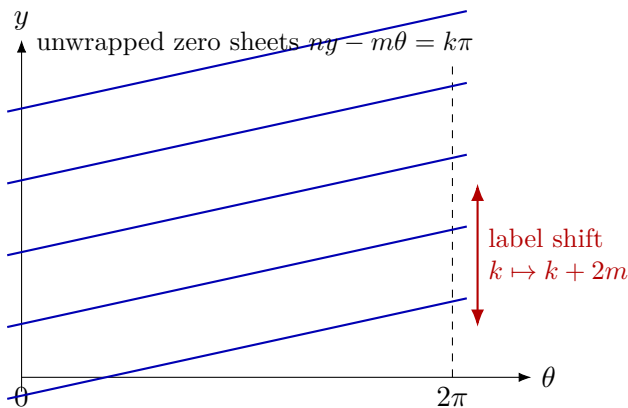


Figure 2: The helical tube on the unwrapped (θ, y) -plane. Vertical boundary identification at $\theta = 0, 2\pi$ produces the permutation (31); the drawing is schematic, while the slope is fixed exactly by $dy/d\theta = m/n$.

6.3 Boundary traces and logarithmic sheets

At either boundary component $x = \pm L$, the trace lies in the parameter-position torus $S_\theta^1 \times S_y^1$ and satisfies

$$ny - m\theta \in \pi\mathbb{Z}.$$

It has $2d$ connected components. Each is a primitive curve with homology class

$$\frac{n}{d}[S_\theta^1] + \frac{m}{d}[S_y^1]. \quad (32)$$

If $T(p, q)$ denotes the torus link whose total homology data in these ordered coordinates are (p, q) , the full trace is $T(2n, 2m)$, up to simultaneous orientation reversal. This statement depends on the declared torus coordinates; it is not an intrinsic knot type before an embedding of that torus in a three-manifold is fixed.

Unwrap the y -circle to $y \in \mathbb{R}$. Formula (30) now has labels $k \in \mathbb{Z}$. The parameter loop sends $k \mapsto k + 2m$, while the deck transformation $y \mapsto y + 2\pi$ sends $k \mapsto k + 2n$. The finite downstairs system is exactly the quotient of this countable label set by the deck action. This simultaneously realizes a proper tube and a nontrivial logarithmic shift.

Corollary 6.5 (Finite quotient of the helical lift). *For the helical family, the countable lifted sheets contain no additional component permutation beyond the affine action generated by the two translations $2m$ and $2n$ on $\mathbb{Z}$. Downstairs component monodromy is their reduction modulo $2n$.*

6.4 Embedded monodromy versus braid monodromy

The permutation (31) is honest monodromy, but it is not an element of B_{2n} . Its fiber consists of intervals in a surface, not points in a disc. Intersecting the zero tube with $x = c$ produces a one-dimensional trace in $S_y^1 \times S_\theta^1$, but the choice of c is additional probe data. Section 9 formalizes this distinction.

Even for compact circle fibers in Theorem 6.1, the abstract monodromy of the one-manifold fiber records only a permutation and orientation-preserving return maps of circles. The embedding in the ambient surface can carry a richer mapping class, but that is a mapping-class problem for curves, not the ordinary braid group of moving points.

7 Singular fibers and branched fillings

7.1 Real Morse events in the singular category

Let $\tau \in \mathbb{R}$ and consider the two functions

$$a_\tau^+(x, y) = x^2 + y^2 - \tau, \quad a_\tau^-(x, y) = x^2 - y^2 - \tau. \quad (33)$$

Their common critical set in each slice is the origin. On $\mathbb{R}^2 \setminus \{0\}$ define

$$g_\tau^\pm = \frac{4(x^2 + y^2)}{\mu^2 + \lambda^2(a_\tau^\pm)^2} (dx^2 + dy^2). \quad (34)$$

Proposition 7.1 (AEG Morse bifurcations). *For every τ , the tuple*

$$(\mathbb{R}^2, \{0\}, g_\tau^\pm, a_\tau^\pm; \mu, \lambda)$$

is a singular AES. Its total zero incidence in $\mathbb{R}^2 \times \mathbb{R}_\tau$ is smooth, but projection to τ has a critical point at $(0, 0, 0)$.

For a_τ^+ , the zero changes from empty to a singular point and then to a circle as τ crosses zero. For a_τ^- , the two hyperbolic branches reconnect through the four regular rays meeting at the singular origin when $\tau = 0$.

Proof. The Euclidean norm squared of $da_\tau^\pm$ is $4(x^2 + y^2)$, so Corollary 2.3 gives the AEG equation and local essentiality. Define $A^\pm(x, y, \tau) = a_\tau^\pm(x, y)$. Since $\partial_\tau A^\pm = -1$, zero is a regular value of the total function; hence $(A^\pm)^{-1}(0)$ is smooth. The parameter projection restricted to it is critical precisely when the spatial derivative vanishes, which happens at the origin. The stated zero sets follow directly from $x^2 + y^2 = \tau$ and $x^2 - y^2 = \tau$. $\square$

The proposition exhibits the key phenomenon

$$\text{smooth total zero incidence} \not\Rightarrow \text{zero tube}.$$

At the event, it is the projection that fails to be a submersion.

7.2 A regular-to-singular fold wall

A related family makes all noncritical slices regular rather than retaining a singular point away from the zero. Put

$$A(x, y, \tau) = e^x(y^2 - \tau).$$

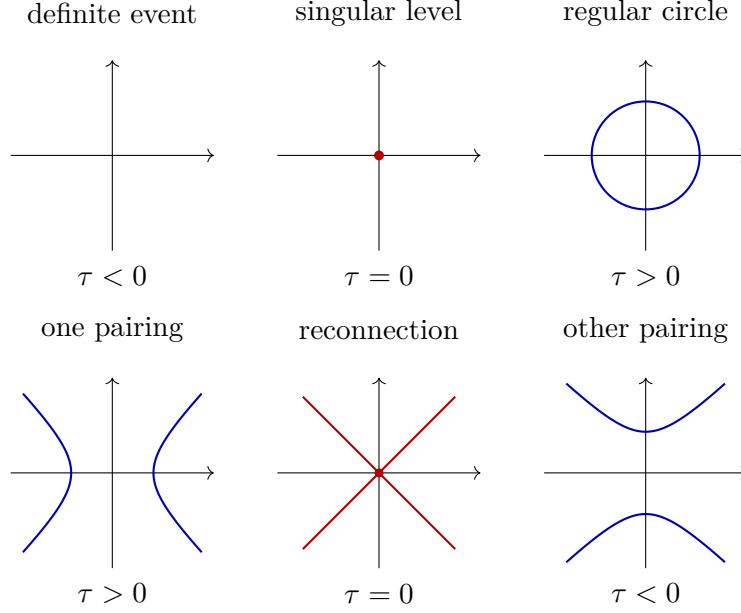


Figure 3: Real AEG-compatible Morse examples. The red point is a declared essential singularity. The pictures record zero topology only; they are not a classification of metric germs.

For $\tau \neq 0$, the spatial derivative never vanishes; for $\tau = 0$, it vanishes along the entire line $y = 0$. On the regular locus use

$$g_\tau = \frac{e^{2x}((y^2 - \tau)^2 + 4y^2)}{\mu^2 + \lambda^2 e^{2x}(y^2 - \tau)^2} (dx^2 + dy^2). \quad (35)$$

For $\tau < 0$ the zero fiber is empty, for $\tau > 0$ it consists of two parallel lines, and for $\tau = 0$ it is the singular line $y = 0$. The metric degenerates there and the line is locally essential. This is a verified wall-crossing family, but it is nonproper and its singular stratum is one-dimensional.

7.3 The complex branch model

Real scalar zeros and complex roots have different local models. Let $(w, \tau) \in \mathbb{C}^2$ and consider

$$F(w, \tau) = w^2 - \tau. \quad (36)$$

The incidence $F^{-1}(0)$ is a smooth complex curve parameterized by $w \mapsto (w, w^2)$. Its projection to the τ -plane is a two-sheeted branched cover with a single simple branch point at the origin.

On the boundary circle $\tau = \varepsilon e^{i\theta}$, the two roots are

$$w_\pm(\theta) = \pm \sqrt{\varepsilon} e^{i\theta/2}. \quad (37)$$

They remain distinct for every boundary parameter and exchange after one circuit. The boundary therefore carries the standard half-twist in B_2 ; the collision is at the center of the filling, not on the boundary braid.

Proposition 7.2 (Simple polynomial discriminant normal form). *Let a holomorphic family of monic polynomials, parameterized by a complex d -manifold, meet the polynomial discriminant transversely at a parameter where exactly one root has multiplicity two and all other roots are simple. After*

holomorphic changes of root and parameter coordinates $\tau = (\tau_1, \dots, \tau_d)$, its local root incidence is the disjoint union of simple graphs and one copy of

$$w^2 = \tau_1,$$

with $\tau_2, \dots, \tau_d$ as spectator coordinates.

Proof. Separate the simple roots by the holomorphic implicit-function theorem. The remaining quadratic factor has the form $w^2 + b(\tau)w + c(\tau)$. Translating w removes the linear term. Its discriminant is a holomorphic function of the parameter; transversality makes that function the first member τ_1 of a local coordinate system. Rescaling τ_1 gives (36), while the remaining parameter coordinates pass through unchanged. $\square$

Restricting τ to the real axis gives two real roots for $\tau > 0$ and two imaginary roots for $\tau < 0$. Their four half-arcs meet at the branch point. This four-valent picture is a real slice of a complex branched cover, not a regular four-valent zero of a real assignment.

There is nevertheless a precise relation to Theorem 2.4. If the same local map is regarded spatially as $\Phi(z) = z^2$ and one takes the real assignment $\text{Im } \Phi$, its zero germ is four-pronged and its pulled-back AEG metric has cone angle 4π . In the present subsection, by contrast, $w^2 = \tau$ is an incidence over a parameter plane and the output is root monodromy. The same holomorphic branch supplies two constructions only after the roles of source, target, and parameter have been declared.

7.4 Smooth and holomorphic fillings

Section 8 realizes every braid by a family that is smooth in the loop parameter and holomorphic in the spatial coordinate w . Extending such a family over a parameter disc while remaining holomorphic in both variables is a stronger demand. Algebraic-function boundaries are constrained by quasipositivity [15]. Thus the statements

every braid has an arithmetic-holomorphic spatial realization,
every braid bounds a holomorphic AEG root filling

are not equivalent; the first is proved below, while the second is false without restrictions.

Open problem 7.3 (AEG-natural singular fillings). Determine which branch signs and global braided surfaces arise when the parameter dependence is constrained by expression history or by a natural connection, rather than chosen as an arbitrary smooth or holomorphic polynomial family.

8 Complex roots, monodromy, and braids

8.1 Square-free polynomials as a finite-root interface

Let $\mathcal{P}_n \cong \mathbb{C}^n$ be the space of monic degree- n complex polynomials and let $\Delta_n \subset \mathcal{P}_n$ be its algebraic discriminant. The square-free locus is

$$\mathcal{P}_n^{\text{sf}} = \mathcal{P}_n \setminus \Delta_n.$$

Vieta's map identifies it with the unordered configuration space

$$\mathcal{P}_n^{\text{sf}} \cong \text{UConf}_n(\mathbb{C}) = \text{Conf}_n(\mathbb{C})/S_n. \quad (38)$$

Its fundamental group is the Artin braid group B_n [2, 8, 4].

This is the complex-analytic specialization of the relative zero-divisor picture in Theorem 4.3. Irreducible factors over the coefficient field record arithmetic components; after passing to a complex parameter manifold and removing the discriminant, the geometric sheets form the covering used below. Neither passage identifies sheets with raw expression words.

Theorem 8.1 (Finite-root incidence and braid monodromy). *Let B be a connected smooth manifold and let*

$$F_b(w) = w^n + c_1(b)w^{n-1} + \cdots + c_n(b) \quad (39)$$

be a smooth family of monic polynomials with nonvanishing discriminant. Then

$$\mathcal{R}_F = \{(w, b) \in \mathbb{C} \times B : F_b(w) = 0\} \quad (40)$$

is a smooth real codimension-two submanifold whose projection to B is a proper n -sheeted covering. The coefficient map $c : B \rightarrow \mathcal{P}_n^{\text{sf}}$ induces $c_ : \pi_1(B, b_0) \rightarrow \pi_1(\mathcal{P}_n^{\text{sf}}, c(b_0))$. After choosing the usual path to a standard base configuration and the resulting identification of the target with B_n , this is braid monodromy*

$$c_* : \pi_1(B, b_0) \longrightarrow B_n. \quad (41)$$

Changing that identification conjugates the representation. Its composition with $B_n \rightarrow S_n$ is the ordinary permutation monodromy of the covering $\mathcal{R}_F \rightarrow B$.

Proof. At a root of a square-free polynomial, $\partial F_b / \partial w \neq 0$. The implicit-function theorem therefore writes the root incidence locally as n disjoint graphs over B , so it is an n -sheeted covering. A finite covering of locally compact Hausdorff spaces is proper. The map to unordered root configurations is exactly the coefficient map under (38); functoriality of the fundamental group gives (41). Forgetting paths and retaining only their endpoint labels is the standard quotient $B_n \rightarrow S_n$. $\square$

For $B = S^1$, the incidence is a closed geometric braid in $\mathbb{C} \times S^1$. A basepoint and an ordering above it give an element of B_n ; changing the basepoint or ordering conjugates that element. This is strictly more information than the endpoint permutation.

Warning 8.2 (Rank-one assignments do not yield B_n). The field F in Theorem 8.1 is complex-valued and has real rank two. The theorem does not turn a real AEG assignment into a polynomial, nor does it promote a moving family of zero curves to a finite-root braid. The two constructions share the parameterized zero-section theorem but have different codimensions.

8.2 Arithmetic-holomorphic braid realization

On the complete basic hyperbolic AES with $\mu, \lambda > 0$, Paper II constructs a global coordinate $w = X + iy \in \mathbb{H}$ in which arithmetic holomorphicity is ordinary holomorphicity. This supplies a precise AEG background for Theorem 8.1.

Theorem 8.3 (AEG realization of every braid). *For every $\beta \in B_n$ and every complete basic hyperbolic AES with $\mu, \lambda > 0$, there is a smooth loop of arithmetic-holomorphic fields F_θ such that:*

1. *every F_θ is a monic degree- n polynomial in the arithmetic holomorphic coordinate w ;*
2. *all roots lie in a fixed disc $D \Subset \mathbb{H}$ and remain simple;*
3. *the root incidence realizes the geometric braid β .*

Consequently, every oriented link is the closure of the root incidence of such an arithmetic-holomorphic family.

Proof. Represent β by a smooth loop $\{z_1(\theta), \dots, z_n(\theta)\}$ in $\text{UConf}_n(\mathbb{C})$. On the parameter interval $[0, 2\pi]$, choose a smooth ordered lift $(z_1(\theta), \dots, z_n(\theta))$; its two endpoints may differ by the permutation underlying β . An affine translation and positive rescaling place the compact unordered image in a disc $D \Subset \mathbb{H}$ without changing its braid class. Set

$$F_\theta(w) = \prod_{j=1}^n (w - z_j(\theta)). \quad (42)$$

Because the endpoint lists differ only by a permutation, the coefficients are smooth and periodic in θ . The roots are simple, and each slice is holomorphic in w . Paper II identifies it as an arithmetic-holomorphic field. Its root incidence is the chosen loop of configurations. The last statement follows from Alexander's closed-braid theorem [1]. $\square$

The theorem is a universality result, not an invariant. Because every braid can be realized, the predicate “admits an AEG root-tube realization” cannot distinguish links. New information would have to be supplied by a natural history-derived decoration or by a restricted class of allowed families.

8.3 Logarithmic lifting of root tubes

Suppose all roots avoid the origin. Pull the root incidence back along $\exp : \mathbb{C} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^\times$:

$$\tilde{\mathcal{R}}_F = \{(b, \omega) : F_b(e^\omega) = 0\}. \quad (43)$$

Theorem 8.4 (Logarithmic root transport and gauge). *The map $\tilde{\mathcal{R}}_F \rightarrow \mathcal{R}_F$ is the canonical principal $2\pi i\mathbb{Z}$ -cover obtained by pullback of the exponential cover. Its specified deck-translation action is $\omega \mapsto \omega + 2\pi i k$. Along a parameter loop, choose a labeling of the initial roots and logarithmic lifts. If root continuation has permutation σ , then there are integers k_i such that*

$$\omega_i(1) = \omega_{\sigma(i)}(0) + 2\pi i k_i. \quad (44)$$

Changing the initial lifts by $\omega_i(0) \mapsto \omega_i(0) + 2\pi i m_i$ changes the integers by

$$k_i \mapsto k_i + m_i - m_{\sigma(i)}. \quad (45)$$

For every cycle of σ , the sum of the k_i on that cycle is gauge invariant. Relabeling the roots permutes these cycle sums, so their multiset, rather than an ordered list, is label-independent. The total sum $\sum_i k_i$ is gauge and label invariant and equals the winding of the product of the roots around zero.

Proof. Equation (43) is the pullback of the exponential cover, so the first claim is immediate. Unique path lifting gives (44). If the initial lift of the i th path is shifted by $2\pi i m_i$, its entire lift is shifted by that amount. Comparing the new endpoint with the new lift assigned to the root $\sigma(i)$ gives (45). The m_i terms telescope around each permutation cycle. Finally, the product of all roots is, up to sign, the constant coefficient of F_b ; summing logarithmic increments computes its winding. $\square$

Thus a vector (k_i) is not an invariant before a lift gauge is fixed. Cycle sums are invariant but abelian. The full noncommutative information remains in the configuration path, more precisely in the annular braid group when roots are constrained to $\mathbb{C}^\times$.

8.4 Boundary braid and discriminant filling

Theorem 8.1 applies only in the complement of Δ_n . A filling disc may meet the discriminant. At a transverse simple intersection, Proposition 7.2 gives $w^2 = \tau$, and its boundary loop contributes a conjugate of a standard positive or negative half-twist according to orientation. The collision is therefore a two-cell event in the filling, while the boundary braid stays collision-free.

This separation resolves an otherwise persistent ambiguity:

Object	Allowed local event	Output
regular real assignment family	no critical zero	curve tube
singular real family	Morse critical zero	birth or reconnection
square-free boundary root family	no repeated root	braid monodromy
root filling through Δ_n	simple double root	branch half-twist

Open problem 8.5 (Natural braid monodromy). Find a functorial procedure that assigns a finite complex-root field to an expression history or to a real zero tube, and prove that the resulting braid is independent of auxiliary coordinates and probes. The arbitrary polynomial realization of Theorem 8.3 does not solve this problem. In particular, a solution should be compatible with the history-to-divisor functor requested in Problem 4.6.

9 Threading, affine torsion, and the knot frontier

9.1 Threads are additional data

The real zero tube has curve fibers. To obtain moving points one must select them.

Definition 9.1 (Finite zero thread). Let $\pi : \mathcal{Z} \rightarrow B$ be an embedded real zero tube over a connected one-manifold. A *finite zero thread* is a properly embedded one-dimensional submanifold $K \subset \mathcal{Z}$, with $\partial K = K \cap \pi^{-1}(\partial B)$ when the base has boundary, such that $\pi|_K : K \rightarrow B$ is a finite-sheeted covering. For $B = S^1$, this forces K to be a compact one-manifold without boundary. The pair $(\mathcal{Z}, K)$ is a *threaded zero tube*. A thread is *intrinsic* only if its construction from the stated AEG data is functorial under the declared notion of AEG isomorphism.

In the helical family, every slice $x = c$ gives

$$K_c = \mathcal{Z}(A_{m,n}) \cap \{x = c\},$$

a degree- $2n$ finite thread. Its homology and component structure are computed in (32). The choice of c is a probe choice; if one uses $c = \pm L$, the boundary is part of the domain data but the choice of boundary component remains. Selecting only one of the $2d$ components is another choice.

A rank-two root incidence such as $\mathcal{R}_F$ is already one-dimensional, so it plays the role of its own finite thread. If its moving points lie in a disc, it is an ordinary geometric braid. If they lie in an annulus or general surface, the relevant surface braid group and equivalence relation must be named.

9.2 A scalar Markov obstruction

The first novelty filter is independent of AEG.

Proposition 9.2 (Stateless additive collapse). *Let A be an abelian group and $n \geq 2$. Every homomorphism $\Theta_n : B_n \rightarrow A$ factors through the exponent sum (writhe) $w : B_n \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$:*

$$\Theta_n(\beta) = w(\beta)c_n$$

for a fixed $c_n \in A$. If the family Θ_n is compatible with the standard inclusions $B_n \hookrightarrow B_{n+1}$ and is unchanged under both Markov stabilizations $\beta \mapsto \beta\sigma_n^{\pm 1}$, then every Θ_n is zero.

Proof. In an abelian target, the braid relation $\sigma_i\sigma_{i+1}\sigma_i = \sigma_{i+1}\sigma_i\sigma_{i+1}$ implies $\Theta_n(\sigma_i) = \Theta_n(\sigma_{i+1})$. All standard generators therefore have the same image c_n , and the homomorphism is exponent sum times c_n . Inclusion compatibility identifies c_n with c_{n+1} . Positive stabilization then gives $c_{n+1} = 0$; negative stabilization gives the same conclusion. Hence the family vanishes. $\square$

Allowing a normalization depending on strand number does not evade both signs. If $I_n(\beta) = cw(\beta) + dn$ in an additive coefficient group, positive and negative stabilization require $c + d = 0$ and $-c + d = 0$. Away from two-torsion this forces $c = d = 0$, and in all cases it leaves no noncommutative information. A useful AEG invariant must retain state, use a trace-like normalization, or belong to a more structured category.

9.3 Affine conjugation and the Alexander layer

Let R be a commutative ring. Write an affine transformation as (p, u) , with $p \in R^\times$ and $u \in R$, acting by $x \mapsto px + u$. Thus all multipliers p, q, r below are units and all translation coordinates u, v, w lie in R . We use

$$(p, u)(q, v) = (pq, u + pv), \quad (p, u)^{-1} = (p^{-1}, -p^{-1}u). \quad (46)$$

Right conjugation $x \triangleright y = y^{-1}xy$ is

$$(p, u) \triangleright (q, v) = (p, q^{-1}(u + (p - 1)v)). \quad (47)$$

On the fixed-multiplier branch $X_t = \{(t, u) : u \in R\}$ over a commutative ring in which t is a unit, this becomes

$$u \triangleright v = t^{-1}u + (1 - t^{-1})v. \quad (48)$$

It is exactly an Alexander quandle, not a structure beyond the Alexander layer.

The affine torsion expression

$$\kappa((p, u), (q, v)) = (1 - q)u + (p - 1)v \quad (49)$$

restricts to

$$\kappa_t(u, v) = (t - 1)(v - u). \quad (50)$$

Proposition 9.3 (Ordinary exactness). *With the ordinary quandle coboundary convention $df(x, y) = f(x \triangleright y) - f(x)$, one has*

$$\kappa_t = d(tf) \quad \text{for } f(u) = u.$$

Thus the fixed-multiplier affine torsion represents the zero ordinary quandle cohomology class.

Proof. Equation (48) gives

$$df(u, v) = (t^{-1} - 1)u + (1 - t^{-1})v = \frac{t - 1}{t}(v - u).$$

Multiplication by t gives (50). $\square$

9.4 Twisting, resonance, and a nonzero class

We now use the twisted convention of Carter–Elhamdadi–Saito [5]. Let the coefficient action be a scalar T_{coef} . A normalized twisted 2-cocycle ϕ satisfies

$$T_{\text{coef}}\phi(x, y) + \phi(x \triangleright y, z) = T_{\text{coef}}\phi(x, z) + (1 - T_{\text{coef}})\phi(y, z) + \phi(x \triangleright z, y \triangleright z), \quad (51)$$

and $\phi(x, x) = 0$. For coboundaries we choose the sign

$$\delta_T^\pm f(x, y) = T_{\text{coef}}f(x) + (1 - T_{\text{coef}})f(y) - f(x \triangleright y). \quad (52)$$

The chain-level convention in the cited paper differs from (52) by a global minus sign in one displayed definition, while its extension and state-sum calculations use the sign above. The coboundary subgroup is the same under either choice.

Put $\alpha = t^{-1}$. Direct substitution in (51) shows that κ_t is a twisted cocycle for every coefficient action. If $\alpha - T_{\text{coef}}$ is a unit in the coefficient ring, it is exact: for

$$f(u) = \frac{t - 1}{\alpha - T_{\text{coef}}}u$$

one has $\delta_T^+ f = \kappa_t$. Over a field, only the resonance $T_{\text{coef}} = \alpha$ survives this linear exactness test; over a general ring, a nonzero nonunit difference may also obstruct this particular linear primitive.

Theorem 9.4 (Finite-field resonant affine class). *Let q be a prime power, let $t \in \mathbb{F}_q^\times \setminus \{1\}$, and put $\alpha = t^{-1}$. Give $X_t = \mathbb{F}_q$ the Alexander operation $x \triangleright y = \alpha x + (1 - \alpha)y$ and give the coefficient module $N = \mathbb{F}_q$ the resonant action $T_{\text{coef}} = \alpha$. Then*

$$\kappa_t(x, y) = (t - 1)(y - x) \quad (53)$$

is a normalized twisted 2-cocycle representing a nonzero class in $H_{TQ}^2(X_t; N)$.

Proof. Normalization is immediate, and substituting the Alexander operation into (51) makes both sides equal

$$(t - 1)[z - (\alpha + T_{\text{coef}})x + (\alpha + T_{\text{coef}} - 1)y].$$

Suppose $\kappa_t = \delta_T^+ f$. Subtracting the constant $f(0)$ does not change the coboundary, so take $g(0) = 0$. Setting $y = 0$ gives

$$g(\alpha x) - \alpha g(x) = (t - 1)x. \quad (54)$$

Let $r = \text{ord}(\alpha)$. Iterating (54) yields

$$g(\alpha^r x) = \alpha^r g(x) + r(t - 1)\alpha^{r-1}x.$$

But $\alpha^r = 1$ and r divides $q - 1$, so the characteristic of $\mathbb{F}_q$ does not divide r . Taking $x \neq 0$ contradicts $t \neq 1$. Hence no one-cochain has coboundary κ_t . $\square$

This closes the algebraic resonance question, but it does not yet produce a stronger classical knot invariant. In fact, a second calculation gives a sharp collapse theorem.

We now fix the precise planar state-sum convention. Give each oriented arc the normal for which the ordered pair (tangent, normal) agrees with the plane orientation, and give the unbounded region Alexander number zero. At a crossing τ , let $L(\tau)$ be the Alexander number of the source region from which both arc normals point. Let y_τ be the over-arc color, and let its normal point from

an under-arc colored x_τ to one colored $x_\tau \triangleright y_\tau$. Define $\epsilon(\tau) = 1$ when the ordered pair (over-arc normal, under-arc normal) agrees with the plane orientation and $\epsilon(\tau) = -1$ otherwise. In additive coefficient notation the twisted Boltzmann weight is

$$B_T(\tau, C) = T_{\text{coef}}^{-L(\tau)}(\epsilon(\tau)\kappa_t(x_\tau, y_\tau)) \in N, \quad (55)$$

and the state sum is

$$\Phi_{\kappa_t}(D) = \sum_{C \in \text{Col}_{X_t}(D)} \left[\sum_{\tau} B_T(\tau, C) \right] \in \mathbb{Z}[N]. \quad (56)$$

Here $[a]$ denotes the basis element of the integral group ring indexed by $a \in N$. This is the additive form of the standard twisted convention.

Theorem 9.5 (Planar state-sum collapse). *Under the hypotheses of Theorem 9.4, the standard twisted quandle cocycle state sum (56) is a Reidemeister invariant of oriented classical links, but for every planar link diagram D it is*

$$\Phi_{\kappa_t}(D) = |\text{Col}_{X_t}(D)|[0]. \quad (57)$$

Thus it provides no enhancement of the Alexander quandle coloring count.

Proof. The Reidemeister invariance follows from the standard twisted-cocycle theorem [5]. To identify the value, define the two-dimensional $\mathbb{F}_q$ -vector space $E = N \oplus X_t$ with Laurent action

$$T_E(a, x) = (\alpha a - (t-1)x, \alpha x). \quad (58)$$

This is invertible and makes $0 \rightarrow N \rightarrow E \rightarrow X_t \rightarrow 0$ a short exact sequence of Alexander modules. For the section $s(x) = (0, x)$,

$$T_E s(x) + (1 - T_E)s(y) - s(x \triangleright y) = (\kappa_t(x, y), 0). \quad (59)$$

Hence κ_t is the obstruction cocycle of an Alexander-module extension. The planar obstruction-cocycle cancellation theorem of Carter–Elhamdadi–Saito then makes every coloring contribute the identity weight. With convention (56), the state sum is therefore exactly $|\text{Col}_{X_t}(D)|[0]$. $\square$

Theorems 9.4 and 9.5 illustrate why cohomological nontriviality and knot-theoretic detection must be tested separately. A nonzero class can have a trivial planar enhancement because its weights cancel through an extension. On diagrams in nonplanar surfaces, the same extension argument need not cancel; that is a different, surface-link question and is not promoted here to an ordinary S^3 invariant.

9.5 Variable multipliers and the Reidemeister-III anomaly

For the full affine quandle, the torsion (49) is generally not an ordinary 2-cocycle. With $x = (p, u)$, $y = (q, v)$, and $z = (r, w)$, define its type-III defect by

$$\mathfrak{A}_\kappa(x, y, z) = \kappa(x, y) + \kappa(x \triangleright y, z) - \kappa(x, z) - \kappa(x \triangleright z, y \triangleright z).$$

A direct calculation gives

$$\mathfrak{A}_\kappa(x, y, z) = \frac{(q-r)(r-1)}{qr} \kappa(x, y). \quad (60)$$

It vanishes on a fixed-multiplier branch, as it must. On a one-component knot, conjugate meridians also have equal multipliers, so arbitrary multiplier variation along arcs is not legitimate coloring data. Nonzero use of (60) would require additional region state, a multi-component setting, a dynamical quandle, or another declared structure.

Warning 9.6 (Anomaly is not associator). A failure of the ordinary type-III cocycle equation is not automatically a higher associator or a surface-holonomy invariant. Such an interpretation requires separate pentagon/hexagon or equivalent coherence and filling-independence proofs.

9.6 A historical free-word calculation

One useful repository computation can be stated without overclaiming it. Use the historical figure-eight knot-group presentation

$$G_{4_1} = \langle a, b \mid abbbaBAAB = 1 \rangle, \quad A = a^{-1}, \quad B = b^{-1}.$$

Under the convention that $a : x \mapsto tx$, $b : x \mapsto x + 1$, uppercase letters denote inverses, and the displayed transformations compose in the fixed word order, the free-group word

$$abbbaBAAB$$

has unit multiplier and translation coordinate

$$-\Delta_{4_1}(t) = -(t^2 - 3t + 1). \quad (61)$$

This is a verified affine word calculation. The displayed generator assignment descends from the free group to G_{4_1} only on the parameter locus $\Delta_{4_1}(t) = 0$. At generic t it is not a knot invariant; it is the failure of the chosen generator assignment to satisfy the relator.

9.7 The remaining invariant gate

Theorem 8.3 supplies every braid, and Definition 9.1 supplies explicit threads in selected real tubes. Neither result selects a choice-free numerical or algebraic decoration. For a family $I_n : B_n \rightarrow \mathcal{A}$ to descend to oriented links via Markov's theorem, it must at minimum satisfy

$$\begin{aligned} I_n(\gamma\beta\gamma^{-1}) &= I_n(\beta), \\ I_{n+1}(\iota_n\beta\sigma_n) &= I_n(\beta), \\ I_{n+1}(\iota_n\beta\sigma_n^{-1}) &= I_n(\beta). \end{aligned} \quad (62)$$

after any declared normalization [4]. An AEG construction must additionally prove independence of logarithmic lift, probe, thread, spine, axis, basepoint, and expression presentation whenever those are auxiliary choices.

Open problem 9.7 (AEG Markov descent). Construct a nonabelian or stateful decoration natural under AEG isomorphisms, prove the braid relations and all choice-independence statements, and find a Markov normalization satisfying (62).

Open problem 9.8 (Separation beyond Alexander and Burau). After Problem 9.7 is solved, exhibit two oriented links with the same declared Alexander/Burau baseline but different AEG invariant. A stronger braid representation without closure descent does not meet this criterion.

9.8 Conclusion

The singular-zero programme now has a linked analytic, arithmetic, and topological core. Holomorphic pullback turns degree- m ramification into a $2m$ -pronged essential zero and a $2\pi m$ cone. For the projective operators generated by $z \mapsto z + \sqrt{2}$ and $z \mapsto -1/z$, the normalized Hecke Hauptmodul makes this mechanism global: its $\{\infty, 4\}$ dessin is an exact singular AEG zero network, and its

assignment descends with a nontrivial sign character. This replaces a postulated apeirogonal drawing by a zero graph derived from an arithmetic operator group.

The relative-divisor theorem then separates three meanings that the geometry alone cannot distinguish: irreducibility over the coefficient field, geometric sheets after scalar extension, and analytic monodromy away from the discriminant. A general functor from marked histories to those divisors remains open, so the Hecke model is claimed only at the projective-operator quotient level.

Downstream, regular real assignments produce curve tubes under properness; their compact circle-parameter total spaces are tori. The helical family makes component transport, deck lifting, and selected threads explicit. Singular AEG metrics realize the two elementary real Morse events, while complex root fillings isolate the branch half-twist. Paper II's function theory realizes every braid by arithmetic-holomorphic roots.

The same analysis locates the frontier. Flexible metrics and the $\sin(1/z)$ control make analytic existence abundant, while universal braid realization makes mere representability nondiscriminating. Stateless scalars collapse to writhe. Fixed affine multipliers reduce to an Alexander quandle; their ordinary torsion is exact. Resonant twisting gives a genuinely nonzero cohomology class, but its planar classical-link state sum still collapses to the coloring count. The remaining original problem is therefore not to draw another tube. It is to construct the history-to-divisor functor, derive a stateful decoration from it, and prove that the decoration survives every quotient required to become a knot invariant.

A Metric, regularity, and properness calculations

A.1 Conformal scaling identity

If $g = \rho h$ on a surface, then $g^{-1} = \rho^{-1}h^{-1}$. Therefore, for any smooth real function a ,

$$|\nabla a|_g^2 = |da|_{g^{-1}}^2 = \rho^{-1} |da|_h^2. \quad (63)$$

Taking $\rho = |da|_h^2/(\mu^2 + \lambda^2 a^2)$ proves Theorem 2.2. The construction is valid exactly where $da \neq 0$; at a critical point the displayed coefficient vanishes and is not a Riemannian metric.

For $a_h = e^x h(y)$,

$$\partial_x a_h = e^x h, \quad \partial_y a_h = e^x h',$$

which gives Equation (6). For the helical assignment, writing $\xi = ny - m\theta$ gives

$$\partial_x A = ne^{nx} \sin \xi, \quad \partial_y A = ne^{nx} \cos \xi,$$

so $|d^V A|^2 = n^2 e^{2nx}$ independently of ξ . This cancellation is the reason the helical metric has the particularly simple numerator in (29).

A.2 Vertical transversality in coordinates

Locally trivialize $q : X \rightarrow B$ and $E \rightarrow X$ near a zero so that $X \cong U \times V$ and $E \cong (U \times V) \times \mathbb{R}^r$, with $U \subset \mathbb{R}^m$ a fiber chart and $V \subset \mathbb{R}^k$ a base chart. The section becomes a map $s(u, b) \in \mathbb{R}^r$. Vertical transversality says that the $r \times m$ matrix $D_u s$ has rank r . The full Jacobian $(D_u s, D_b s)$ then has rank r , proving that $s^{-1}(0)$ has dimension $m + k - r$.

To see the projection submersion explicitly, solve

$$D_u s \dot{u} = -D_b s \dot{b}$$

for $\dot{u}$ using surjectivity of $D_u s$. Then $(\dot{u}, \dot{b})$ is tangent to the incidence and projects to the arbitrary vector $\dot{b}$. This is the local linear-algebra content of Theorem 5.2.

A.3 Properness checks

For the helical model, $M_L \times S^1$ is compact and the zero incidence is the inverse image of the closed set $\{0\}$ under a continuous function. It is therefore compact, and every map from it to the Hausdorff circle is proper. At $x = \pm L$, the vertical normal to the boundary is ∂_x , while $\partial_y A \neq 0$ on the zero set. Hence the zero incidence is neat and its boundary projects submersively.

For the escape family of Proposition 5.5, fix any $\varepsilon > 0$ and set $t_j = \varepsilon/(j+1)$. The sequence

$$(x_j, y_j, t_j) = (0, t_j^{-1}, t_j)$$

lies in the zero incidence above $[0, \varepsilon]$ and leaves every compact subset of $\mathbb{R}^2 \times [0, \varepsilon]$. This is a direct certificate that the incidence projection is not proper.

A.4 Audit records for the explicit models

The following records make all data and limitations explicit.

Cylindrical product model. Domain $\mathbb{R} \times S^1$; metric $dr^2 + d\phi^2$; assignment $(\mu/\lambda) \sinh(\lambda(r-c))$ for $\lambda \neq 0$ and $\mu(r-c)$ for $\lambda = 0$; singular set empty; equation verified by differentiation; zero topology one circle; compact parameter base gives a proper product incidence; status: proved.

Parallel multi-zero model. Domain $\mathbb{R}^2$; metric (6); assignment $e^x h(y)$; singular set empty when all zeros of h are simple; equation verified by conformal realization; zero topology one line for each zero of h ; no parameter required; completeness not asserted; status: proved, newly constructed in this paper.

Logarithmic model. Downstairs domain $\mathbb{C}^\times$, upstairs domain $\mathbb{C}$; metrics and assignments in (8) and (9); singular set empty; equation verified by pullback; two zero components downstairs and countably many upstairs; deck action $k \mapsto k+2$; missing origin removable; status: proved covering model, not an essential singular AES.

Holomorphic branched pullback. Domain a Riemann surface Σ ; map a nonconstant holomorphic $\Phi : \Sigma \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$; assignment $\text{Im } \Phi$; metric (2); singular set $\text{Crit}(\Phi)$; equation verified by pullback from the linear target AES; a degree- m critical zero has $2m$ prongs and a $2\pi m$ metric cone; status: proved local theorem, with no claim that an arbitrary Φ is history-natural.

Finite Blaschke bridge. Domain $\mathbb{D}$; map a finite Blaschke product B ; finite divisor $B^{-1}(0)$; phase assignments and metrics as in Example 2.6; singular set $\text{Crit}(B)$ for the phase model and $B^{-1}(0) \cup \text{Crit}(B)$ for the pulled-back radial disc model; zero topology a finite holomorphic divisor or the preimage of a real diameter, depending on field rank; status: proved finite bridge, but its freely selected roots are not a history-derived invariant.

Essential sine control. Domain a disc with declared singular set $\{0\} \cup \{(\pi/2 + k\pi)^{-1}\}$; assignment $\text{Im} \sin(1/z)$ and metric in Example 2.7; zero topology one real-axis branch and countably many circles, with four-pronged 4π cone nodes accumulating at the essential singularity; status: proved analytic-capacity example, not the arithmetic model.

$q = 4$ Hecke–Hauptmodul model. Domain $\mathbb{H}$; normalized Hauptmodul β with orbifold signature $(2, 4, \infty)$, finite ramification indices 2 and 4, and a simple pole at the cusp; singular set $\mathcal{E}_4 = \beta^{-1}(1)$; assignment and metric (18); equation verified in the local coordinate $\log W$; zero topology $\beta^{-1}([0, 1])$, which becomes the $\{\infty, 4\}$ Hecke graph after bivalent vertices are suppressed; order-4 nodes have four prongs and cone angle 4π upstairs; the metric descends while the assignment descends as a sign-line-bundle section; regular locus incomplete at the cone nodes, completed full quotient a complete length space with its cusp at infinite distance; status: proved from the normalized automorphic quotient, at the projective-operator history level only.

Helical model. Domain $[-L, L] \times S^1$; parameter $\theta \in S^1$; metric (29); assignment (28); singular set empty; equation verified above; each zero fiber has $2n$ intervals; total incidence has $2 \gcd(n, m)$ annuli and is proper with neat boundary; status: proved.

Morse models. Domain $\mathbb{R}^2$, singular set $\{0\}$, parameter $\tau \in \mathbb{R}$; metric (34); assignments (33); equation verified on the punctured plane; definite birth/death and indefinite reconnection; the total zero incidence is smooth but its parameter projection is critical; status: proved examples, not universal AEG normal forms.

Complex branch model. Background is the basic hyperbolic AES from Paper II with $\mu, \lambda > 0$; field $F_\tau(w) = w^2 - \tau$ is complex-valued and arithmetic holomorphic in w ; the field is not the real assignment; root incidence is smooth, projection has one simple branch point; boundary gives a half-twist; status: proved local root model.

A.5 Completeness warning

Conformal realization does not preserve completeness. If a conformal coefficient ρ decays rapidly along an end, an h -infinite path may have finite $g = \rho h$ length. In the parallel examples, the factor e^{2x} commonly makes $x \rightarrow -\infty$ a finite-distance end. Any theorem that needs complete fibers must therefore add completeness as a hypothesis and recheck each model; it cannot infer it from the eikonal identity.

The Hecke model illustrates the required distinction. Its regular locus is incomplete because the deleted order-4 points lie at finite distance. The singular length completion adjoins 4π cone points, while the cusp coordinate has metric asymptotic to $|dq/q|^2$ and is at infinite distance. This audited completion does not turn a cone point into a smooth regular AES point.

B Configuration spaces, logarithmic lifts, and branch signs

B.1 Configuration and braid conventions

The ordered configuration space of n points in a surface S is

$$\text{Conf}_n(S) = \{(z_1, \dots, z_n) \in S^n : z_i \neq z_j \text{ for } i \neq j\},$$

and $\text{UConf}_n(S) = \text{Conf}_n(S)/S_n$. For the plane, $\pi_1(\text{UConf}_n(\mathbb{C})) = B_n$. Our generators σ_i exchange the i th and $(i+1)$ st points by a positive half-twist and satisfy

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma_i \sigma_j &= \sigma_j \sigma_i & (|i - j| \geq 2), \\ \sigma_i \sigma_{i+1} \sigma_i &= \sigma_{i+1} \sigma_i \sigma_{i+1}. \end{aligned}$$

The quotient $B_n \rightarrow S_n$ remembers only endpoint permutation, and the abelianization $B_n \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ sends every σ_i to 1.

The identification (38) sends an unordered set of roots to the elementary symmetric coefficients of its monic polynomial. It is a homeomorphism, with smooth complex-manifold structure on the square-free locus. The classical configuration-space fibrations supply one standard route to the fundamental-group computation [8].

B.2 Properness of a finite root covering

Let $p : Y \rightarrow B$ be a finite-sheeted covering with B locally compact Hausdorff. For a compact set $K \subset B$, cover K by finitely many relatively compact evenly covered neighborhoods. The closure of each sufficiently small sheet is homeomorphic to a compact closure downstairs. A finite union contains $p^{-1}(K)$ as a closed subset, so $p^{-1}(K)$ is compact. Thus p is proper. Applied to the root incidence, this proof uses square-freeness locally and the fixed finite degree globally. Monicity prevents a root from disappearing to infinity while the coefficient remains at a fixed point of B .

B.3 Gauge calculation for logarithmic roots

Let $z_i(s)$ be the continuation path beginning at the i th labeled root. If $z_i(1) = z_{\sigma(i)}(0)$ and ω_i is its logarithmic lift, then

$$\omega_i(1) - \omega_{\sigma(i)}(0) \in 2\pi i\mathbb{Z}.$$

This defines k_i . Shift initial lifts by $m_j \in \mathbb{Z}$. Unique path lifting gives

$$\omega'_i(s) = \omega_i(s) + 2\pi i m_i,$$

and hence

$$\begin{aligned} \omega'_i(1) &= \omega_{\sigma(i)}(0) + 2\pi i(k_i + m_i) \\ &= \omega'_{\sigma(i)}(0) + 2\pi i(k_i + m_i - m_{\sigma(i)}). \end{aligned}$$

This proves (45). If $i_1 \mapsto i_2 \mapsto \cdots \mapsto i_\ell \mapsto i_1$ is a permutation cycle, then

$$\sum_{j=1}^{\ell} (m_{i_j} - m_{\sigma(i_j)}) = 0.$$

The cycle sum of deck shifts is therefore lift-gauge invariant, whereas each summand is not. Relabeling the roots permutes the cycles, so the unordered multiset of cycle sums is canonical.

The total sum has an algebraic expression. If the roots are $z_i(b)$, then

$$\prod_i z_i(b) = (-1)^n c_n(b).$$

The winding of the constant coefficient around zero equals the sum of the root windings and hence $\sum_i k_i$.

B.4 Helical trace on the parameter-position torus

On $S_\theta^1 \times S_y^1$, the equation $ny - m\theta \in \pi\mathbb{Z}$ is the inverse image of the two values 0 and π under the group homomorphism

$$(\theta, y) \mapsto ny - m\theta \pmod{2\pi}.$$

The kernel of the homomorphism with coefficient vector $(-m, n)$ has $d = \gcd(n, m)$ components. Each of the two inverse images is a translate of that kernel, giving $2d$ components in total. A primitive parameterization of any component is

$$s \mapsto \left(\theta_0 + \frac{n}{d}s, y_0 + \frac{m}{d}s \right), \quad s \in \mathbb{R}/(2\pi\mathbb{Z}),$$

which proves (32). With the ordered torus-link convention declared in Section 6, the union is $T(2n, 2m)$.

B.5 The sign of the simple half-twist

For $w^2 = \tau$ on the positively oriented boundary $\tau = \varepsilon e^{i\theta}$, choose at $\theta = 0$ the ordering $(-\sqrt{\varepsilon}, +\sqrt{\varepsilon})$. As θ increases, both points turn counterclockwise through angle π and exchange. Under the convention that a counterclockwise exchange in the root plane is positive, the braid is σ_1 . Reversing the boundary orientation gives σ_1^{-1} . Changing the local coordinate w by an orientation-preserving complex affine map does not change this sign.

This local sign does not determine a global filling. If a parameter disc meets the discriminant in several transverse points, the boundary braid is a product of conjugates of signed half-twists, with order determined by a choice of paths from a basepoint. Holomorphic dependence restricts the possible signs and factorizations; the quasipositive boundary theorem is the relevant classical constraint [15].

B.6 Closure equivalence

Alexander's theorem says that every oriented link in S^3 has a closed-braid representative. Markov's theorem says that two braids have isotopic oriented closures precisely after a sequence generated by braid conjugation and positive or negative stabilization, allowing changes of strand number. Accordingly, a quantity on B_n is not a classical link invariant until the three identities in (62), with its chosen normalization, are proved. If the braid axis is retained, one obtains an annular invariant under a smaller equivalence relation; it must not be relabeled an ordinary S^3 invariant.

C Affine and twisted-quandle calculations

C.1 Conjugation in the affine group

From (46),

$$\begin{aligned} (q, v)^{-1}(p, u)(q, v) &= (q^{-1}, -q^{-1}v)(p, u)(q, v) \\ &= (p, q^{-1}(u - v) + q^{-1}pv) \\ &= (p, q^{-1}(u + (p - 1)v)), \end{aligned}$$

which proves (47). The multiplier of the left input is preserved by conjugation. Consequently each fixed-multiplier set is a subquandle, and taking $p = q = t$ gives (48).

The torsion expression can be recognized as the difference between the translation parts of the two affine products. More precisely, define the translation-coordinate projection by $\text{trans}(p, u) = u$. Then

$$\text{trans}((p, u)(q, v)) - \text{trans}((q, v)(p, u)) = (1 - q)u + (p - 1)v.$$

This verifies (49) and its fixed-branch restriction.

C.2 Twisted cocycle and primitive

Write $c = t - 1$, $\alpha = t^{-1}$, and let the coefficient action be multiplication by β . For $\phi(x, y) = c(y - x)$, the left-hand side of (51), divided by c , is

$$\beta(y - x) + z - (\alpha x + (1 - \alpha)y) = z - (\alpha + \beta)x + (\alpha + \beta - 1)y.$$

The right-hand side is

$$\begin{aligned} & \beta(z - x) + (1 - \beta)(z - y) \\ & + (\alpha y + (1 - \alpha)z) - (\alpha x + (1 - \alpha)z) \\ & = z - (\alpha + \beta)x + (\alpha + \beta - 1)y. \end{aligned}$$

Thus ϕ is a twisted cocycle for every β .

For $f(x) = Cx$, convention (52) gives

$$\delta_T^+ f(x, y) = C(\alpha - \beta)(y - x).$$

If $\alpha - \beta$ is invertible, choosing $C = c/(\alpha - \beta)$ proves nonresonant exactness. At $\beta = \alpha$, this calculation vanishes for every linear f , but Theorem 9.4 is stronger: it excludes every set-theoretic one-cochain over the finite field.

For completeness, the induction used there follows from $g(\alpha x) = \alpha g(x) + cx$:

$$\begin{aligned} g(\alpha^{j+1}x) &= \alpha g(\alpha^j x) + c\alpha^j x \\ &= \alpha^{j+1}g(x) + (j+1)c\alpha^j x. \end{aligned}$$

C.3 The extension calculation

Relative to the ordered basis of $E = N \oplus X_t$, the operator in (58) is

$$[T_E] = \begin{pmatrix} \alpha & -(t-1) \\ 0 & \alpha \end{pmatrix}, \quad \det[T_E] = \alpha^2 \neq 0.$$

Thus it defines an Alexander module. With $s(x) = (0, x)$,

$$\begin{aligned} T_E s(x) &= (-(t-1)x, \alpha x), \\ (1 - T_E)s(y) &= ((t-1)y, (1-\alpha)y). \end{aligned}$$

Their sum is $(\kappa_t(x, y), x \triangleright y)$, which proves (59). Equivalently, the Alexander operation on E is

$$(a, x) * (b, y) = (\alpha a + (1 - \alpha)b + \kappa_t(x, y), x \triangleright y).$$

This is the explicit extension behind Theorem 9.5.

C.4 Two coloring-count checks

The state sum uses crossing weights modified by the Alexander numbering of the source region. The extension theorem makes the total weight zero for every planar coloring, so only the number of colorings remains. Two small cases check the result.

For the positive two-strand braid, use the coloring map

$$B(a, b) = (b, a \triangleright b).$$

Writing $d = b - a$, iteration gives $d_{j+1} = -\alpha d_j$.

The closure of B^2 is the positive Hopf link. Its fixed-point equation forces $(1 - \alpha)d = 0$, so $d = 0$ because $t \neq 1$. Hence

$$\Phi_{\kappa_t}(H) = q[0]. \quad (64)$$

The closure of B^3 is the positive trefoil. Its fixed-point equation is $(\alpha^2 - \alpha + 1)d = 0$, giving

$$\Phi_{\kappa_t}(3_1) = \begin{cases} q^2[0], & \alpha^2 - \alpha + 1 = 0, \\ q[0], & \alpha^2 - \alpha + 1 \neq 0. \end{cases} \quad (65)$$

For $q = 3$ and $t = \alpha = 2$, the values are $3[0]$ and $9[0]$. Their difference is entirely the Alexander-quandle coloring count, not a cocycle enhancement.

C.5 Variable-multiplier defect

Let $K = \kappa(x, y)$. From (47),

$$\begin{aligned} \kappa(x \triangleright y, z) - \kappa(x, z) &= \frac{1-r}{q} K, \\ \kappa(x \triangleright z, y \triangleright z) &= \frac{1}{r} K. \end{aligned}$$

Therefore

$$\begin{aligned} \mathfrak{A}_\kappa(x, y, z) &= \left(1 + \frac{1-r}{q} - \frac{1}{r}\right) K \\ &= \frac{(q-r)(r-1)}{qr} K, \end{aligned}$$

which proves (60). The translation coordinate w of z cancels identically; this does not provide the higher coherence absent from the construction.

C.6 The figure-eight word

With $a = (t, 0)$, $b = (1, 1)$, $A = a^{-1}$, and $B = b^{-1}$, multiply the letters of $abbbaBAAB$ from left to right using (46):

Prefix	Multiplier	Translation
a	t	0
ab	t	t
abb	t	$2t$
$abbb$	t	$3t$
$abbba$	t^2	$3t$
$abbbaB$	t^2	$3t - t^2$
$abbbaBA$	t	$3t - t^2$
$abbbaBAA$	1	$3t - t^2$
$abbbaBAAB$	1	$3t - t^2 - 1$

The final translation is $-(t^2 - 3t + 1)$, proving (61) under the declared convention.

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